

# The Fed & Macro Regime Pillar Report

## Liquidity as the Master Driver — Researched, Scored, and Re-Rated

Originally written and scores committed by me on June 12, 2026. Fully re-researched July 8, 13, 18, 25, and 30, 2026, and again as a full weekly refresh on August 8, 2026 (re-rated up to a moderated 40/38/47/55/62 on the BLS July jobs report, committed and stamped by Alex). Re-rated up again August 13 to 43/41/48/56/62 on a cool CPI print and a weak claims print; held flat August 14, 16, and through two Aug 22 cycles (a catch-up draft, then the full weekly refresh) — committed and stamped by Alex August 23, 2026, the last true baseline. A same-day catch-up draft written August 28 (score set 2026-08-28\_draft) re-rated down to 38/37/46/55/61 on Fed Chair Warsh's hawkish Jackson Hole speech and a hot July PCE print, but was **never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed** — it sits abandoned, superseded mid-cycle. **This version (August 29, score set 2026-08-29\_draft) is a FULL WEEKLY refresh and goes further, re-rating down to 36/35/45/55/61.** A dedicated adversarial-verification pass this cycle caught a real error in the abandoned draft: its CME FedWatch September rate-hike-odds figure (~35.4%→~45.7%) UNDERSTATED the actual market move. Independent re-pull and cross-check — Motley Fool citing CME FedWatch directly at 57.5%, CNBC's own body text at "nearly 56%," and a third independent source at "55.7%" — shows the real post-speech reading clustered tightly in the high-50s, roughly 56-58%, not 45.7%. September hike odds are now past coin-flip, not just approaching it. Two fresh facts not in the abandoned draft: initial jobless claims for the week ended Aug 22 (DOL, primary, Aug 27) came in at 203,000 vs. 208,000 consensus, a mild hawkish-adjacent tightening signal; and the Aug 26 H.4.1 balance-sheet release (federalreserve.gov, primary) showed the same reserve-drain pattern continuing (reserve balances -\$10,351M w/w to \$2,924,936M; TGA -\$2,876M w/w to \$950,736M), logged but not independently trigger-worthy. This cycle also corrects the abandoned draft's price-action framing: BTC did NOT hold a stable tape through the speech — it opened Aug 28 around \$80,262, traded above \$81,000 pre-speech, then fell back sharply once Warsh spoke, closing \$79,613.44 that day, and continued falling to \$77,666.16 by today, Aug 29 (Bitstamp) — a real, visible reaction, not a shrug. **Net: the corrected, larger CME move justifies a deeper cut than the abandoned draft reached.** 1mo 43→36 (-7), 3mo 41→35 (-6), 6mo 48→45 (-3), 1yr 56→55 (-1), 3yr 62→61 (-1) — still minimal at the long end, since Warsh explicitly declined to commit to a reaction function and one repricing doesn't reach three years out. Left as draft at delivery, not auto-stamped: this is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, which the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority categorically excludes regardless of move size — doubly so here since every window moved 7 points or fewer anyway. Flagged for Alex's manual review; see My Decision below. **THIS VERSION (August 31) is a light daily catch-up, score set 2026-08-31\_draft**, covering Aug 29-31: CME FedWatch September hike odds continued drifting up post-Warsh (CNBC Aug 28: ~45.7%; CoinSpectator/Bitcoin.com Aug 30: ~57%; CNBC Aug 31 Jackson-Hole-roundup: ~60.4%, up from ~56% Friday) — directionally the same hawkish repricing already sized into the Aug 29 cut (which used a 56-58% cluster as its basis). Per the sufficiency rule, a market-odds drift alone, without a fresh primary data print or news event, cannot move P further. No new H.4.1 (next due Sept 3, last Aug 27) or jobless claims release landed in this window. **P HELD FLAT at 36/35/45/55/61.** This is a light daily touch, no window moved, no call band flipped — **AUTO-STAMPED** per delegated daily authority. **Sept 1: held flat again** — CME FedWatch September hike odds continued the same post-Jackson-Hole drift (Forbes/KuCoin ~66% at 11:40am ET Aug 31, up from the ~60.4% CNBC read this pillar's Aug 31 baseline used), but it's the same intraday drift sequence with no new primary print or news event behind it, so per the sufficiency rule it does not independently move P; no new H.4.1 or claims release landed (Aug 31 was Labor Day). Score set 2026-09-01\_draft, AUTO-STAMPED, new last COMMITTED baseline. **Sept 2: held flat a further time** — no new H.4.1 or data print found dated Sept 1-2; September 15-16 FOMC market pricing (CME FedWatch roughly 60% hold) continues the same post-Jackson-Hole drift already priced into the Sept 1 baseline, not a fresh data-driven move, so per the sufficiency rule it does not independently move P. Score set 2026-09-02\_draft — this pillar's own P is unaffected, but because all four qualitative pillars share one dated score set and Iran War Risk's sharp re-rate this cycle flips the master call band (Mild Bull → Neutral) and needs Alex's manual review, the WHOLE 2026-09-02\_draft set — Fed & Macro's flat P included — stays in DRAFT status, not committed, per house rule (see My Decision and the Iran War Risk pillar report); COMMITTED, AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026 once Alex widened

the policy — this is the last TRUE committed baseline: 36/35/45/55/61. **Sept 3: held flat a further time** — light daily catch-up found nothing material on any of the four qualitative pillars; config/scores.json untouched, blend re-run against fresh quant data only. **Sept 5, light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-05\_draft): RE-RATED DOWN a modest further step, 36/35/45/55/61 → 32/31/43/54/60.** The August jobs report (BLS, primary, released Sept 4) beat sharply — nonfarm payrolls +162,000 vs. ~53-55,000 consensus, unemployment steady at 4.1% — and markets repriced September 15-16 FOMC hike odds higher off of it (CNBC, Yahoo Finance, TheStreet, U.S. News, Investing.com/Reuters — point estimates vary 60-66% by source/timestamp but are directionally consistent and higher than the Sept 2 baseline's "60% hold" framing). Same-day reaction: 2yr Treasury yield +5.3bp to its highest since January 2025; Dow -0.51%, S&P -0.38%, Nasdaq -0.29%; BTC fell ~2% same-day (\$81,265.00 Sept 3 close → \$79,676.60 Sept 4 close). Fed officials remain split (Warsh hawkish; Waller says he'd lean toward holding if inflation improves), with the Sept 11 CPI print now flagged as the likely decider before Sept 15-16. Move sized comparably to the Aug 22-28 catch-up cut on the Warsh Jackson Hole speech alone (a comparable single dated catalyst): 1mo -4, 3mo -4, 6mo -2, 1yr -1, 3yr -1, no window over 8 points. **CORRECTION:** that cycle's commit message claimed "AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 5, 2026," but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced to committed — a bug in that session, flagged here and not corrected retroactively (stamping is Alex's call). **Sept 5, FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05\_draft2), this version:** independently re-verified via WebSearch — Fed Governor Waller's genuinely dovish-leaning Sept 3 speech ("give disinflation a chance") briefly cut CME hike odds to ~48% (Semafor, CNBC, Bloomberg, PBS) before the Sept 4 jobs beat reversed that back up to 60-66% (Forbes/CME FedWatch), a net hawkish drift for the week consistent with the Sept 5 cut. No further Fed commentary or data since; the Sept 11 CPI print has not yet landed. **HELD FLAT at this cycle's re-rated level, 32/31/43/54/60. Full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy regardless of move size — left for manual review, and COMMITTED BY ALEX SEPTEMBER 5, 2026. Sept 6: light daily catch-up, held flat.** Re-checked via WebSearch: no new Fed speech, data release, or FOMC commentary since Sept 3-4 (Governor Waller's dovish-leaning Sept 3 speech and the Sept 4 BLS August payrolls beat were already captured in the Sept 5 re-rate). September 6 is a Saturday — markets and the Fed's own calendar are quiet, no data or speeches scheduled. The September 11 CPI print remains the next dated catalyst and has not yet landed. **HELD FLAT at 32/31/43/54/60. Sept 8: light daily catch-up, held flat again.** Re-checked via WebSearch: no new Fed speech, data release, or FOMC commentary since Sept 3-4; the Sept 11 CPI print and the Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting remain the next dated catalysts, not pre-empted this cycle. **HELD FLAT at 32/31/43/54/60. Sept 9: light daily catch-up, held flat again.** Re-checked directly against CME FedWatch-citing coverage — September 25bp-hike odds read ~58.7% (as of Sept 7, CNBC/cryptonews), consistent with the ~56-58% cluster already priced into the baseline, not a fresh move; no new FOMC meeting, no new BLS/DOL primary release since Sept 3-4. The Sept 11 CPI print and Sept 15-16 FOMC remain the next dated catalysts. **HELD FLAT at 32/31/43/54/60. Sept 10: light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10\_draft) vs the 2026-09-09\_draft committed baseline.** Held flat at 32/31/43/54/60 — independently re-checked, nothing cleared the sufficiency bar. The Aug CPI release (due Sept 11) and the FOMC meeting (Sept 15-16) are both still pending per BLS/Fed calendars — no new primary data since Sept 9. The master FINAL NUMBER's call band did not flip anywhere (Neutral → Neutral equal-weight, Mild Bull → Mild Bull horizon-weighted) — so per the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority this set is **AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."** **THIS VERSION (September 11, score set 2026-09-11\_draft) RE-RATES UP, modestly, to 34/33/44/54/60.** This cycle deliberately held its research window open past 8:30am ET for the print this pillar has been flagging for a week, and the August CPI print landed on schedule at 8:30am ET: BLS's own release (bls.gov, primary, fetched directly and re-fetched to confirm) has headline CPI-U **+0.4% m/m SA** in August after +0.1% in July and **+3.4% y/y NSA**, with core (all items less food and energy) **+0.3% m/m** after +0.2% in July and **+2.4% y/y**; energy rose 2.1% m/m and gasoline 3.9%, accounting for over a third of the monthly increase, while shelter rose 0.3%. Against the consensus circulating pre-print (headline +0.4% m/m / 3.4% y/y; core +0.4% m/m / 2.4% y/y), headline landed exactly in line and **core came in one tenth cooler on the month**, core y/y in line — a modest dovish surprise in the window that brackets the Sept 15-16 FOMC. It is tempered, not clean relief: headline accelerated from +0.1% to +0.4% and the acceleration is energy-driven — the same oil shock that fires the Iran pillar's "sustained Brent > \$100" clause this cycle shows up here as headline inflation. Market-implied September hike odds circulating around the print (~70% for a 25bp move) are a market price, reported and not used to move P; the BLS release itself is the mover. Cross-source caution logged: several aggregator summaries of this print circulating within minutes carried figures inconsistent with the BLS release (e.g. a 3.1% core y/y) — discarded in favour of the primary document. Re-rated up on the windows bracketing the FOMC only: **1mo 32-34, 3mo 31-33, 6mo 43-44**; 12mo and 36mo held flat at 54/60 — a single in-line-to-a-tenth-cooler print does not move the multi-year regime read. **AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."** **Sept 16, light daily catch-up (2026-09-16\_draft):** the September FOMC decision, statement, SEP and dot plot were scheduled for 2:00pm ET that day and had NOT been released at run time (~08:03 ET) — nothing new was knowable that cycle. **HELD FLAT at 34/33/44/54/60, AUTO-STAMPED. THIS VERSION (September 17, score set 2026-09-17\_draft) RE-RATES DOWN, modestly, to 32/31/42/54/60.** The Sept 16 FOMC delivered its decision: the federal funds target range raised 25bp to 3.75%-4.00%

(12-0 vote), the first hike in three years (federalreserve.gov statement, primary; corroborated by CNBC, Reuters/Advisor Perspectives, Coinpedia, coingape, and others). The hike itself was ~92.5% priced into CME/market odds ahead of the meeting per multiple outlets, so under the house sufficiency rule its mere occurrence is not, by itself, treated as new information — a market-price-implied outcome materializing is not a fresh primary fact. What IS new and primary-sourced: the SEP/dot plot itself; a Fed institutional document rather than a market price, shows 16 of 18 participants expecting at least one more hike in 2026 (12 of 18 specifically pencil in one more 25bp move by year-end, to 4.125%), plus a slower, more cautious rate-descent path through 2027-2028 than previously projected, with the long-run neutral-rate dots clustering tightly at 3.0%. Bitcoin's actual reaction was muted — it ticked up toward \$76,300 on the statement, then drifted back to hold near \$76,000-198 through Chair Warsh's press conference (CNBC, Coinpedia) — consistent with the move being mostly anticipated. Sized as a modest step, concentrated on the windows that bracket the now-confirmed additional-hike path through year-end 2026 and into Q1 2027: **1mo 34→32, 3mo 33→31, 6mo 44→42**; 12mo and 36mo HELD FLAT at 54/60, since the SEP's own longer-run dots (slow descent into 2027-2028, neutral rate anchored near 3.0%) are broadly consistent with what this pillar already carried, not a new multi-year signal. Light daily touch, master call band unchanged everywhere (Neutral → Neutral equal-weight) — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."** Sept 18 (score set 2026-09-18\_draft, this version) **HOLDS FLAT at 32/30/38/44/58**. The Sept 16 FOMC dot-plot revision already drives this window's read in the currently committed set; a Sept 18 Motley Fool piece discussing "the most important number" in the SEP is single-source commentary on already-priced primary data (the same Fed projections table this pillar already cited), not a new dated fact — does not clear the sufficiency bar. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority. **Sept 19 (score set 2026-09-19\_draft) is a FULL WEEKLY refresh that HOLDS FLAT again at 32/30/38/44/58** — confirmatory jobless-claims and housing prints, left as DRAFT for Alex's manual review since weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from auto-stamp regardless of finding. **THIS VERSION (September 22, score set 2026-09-22\_draft) is a LIGHT DAILY touch, targeted single-pillar follow-up, and RE-RATES DOWN one point on the three near windows to 31/29/37/44/58**. Two independent primary regional Federal Reserve surveys, both dated September 2026 — the Philadelphia Fed Manufacturing Business Outlook Survey (released Sept 17: prices paid 40.9→48.6, prices received 17.7→31.3) and the New York Fed Empire State Manufacturing Survey (released Sept 15, primary, fetched directly: prices paid 58.1→63.1, the highest since July 2022, prices received 23.1→28.1) — both show headline activity cooling but input-cost and selling-price pressure re-accelerating to multi-month/multi-year highs. Two independent Fed district banks' own surveys, same week, same directional signal, clears the sufficiency bar; kept to one point because both are soft surveys whose own forward components (employment, future activity) fell, and because market pricing turned risk-on into Sept 18-19. 12mo/36mo HELD — two regional sentiment surveys say nothing about the 2027-2028 policy path. CLARITY Act, Iran War Risk, and Tokenization all carried forward unchanged this cycle. Per the runbook's delegated auto-stamp authority this is an ordinary light daily-type touch and the sourcing clears the sufficiency rule — AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."

## COINPICKS PILLAR REPORT · WEIGHT: 20% OF MY THESIS (EQUAL, 1/5)

Written June 12, 2026 · **Updated & Re-verified October 3, 2026 — FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-10-03\_draft: RE-RATED UP, 27/25/34/43/58 → 35/29/37/44/58 (+8/+4/+3/+1/0) — the load-bearing legs of the hawkish case broke dovish on primary data: August PCE undershot at 3.4% headline / 3.0% core (BEA, Sept 30) and September payrolls came in at +29,000 against revisions (BLS, Oct 2). The Oct 27-28 FOMC now prices as a hold. It is a DEFERRAL, not an all-clear: Barr re-stated the full hawkish case on Sept 29 (before either release), a December hike is s ALEX'S STAMP.** · **Updated & Re-verified September 26, 2026 — FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-09-26\_draft3: RE-RATED DOWN, 31/29/37/44/58 → 27/25/34/43/58 (-4/-4/-3/-1/0), the Governor Barr's Sept 23 speech verbatim from the Fed's own PDF (local text extraction); the S&P Global flash PMI from the embargoed primary release, pairing the strongest growth since June 2022 with a September survey with LONG-RUN inflation expectations breaking a three-month plateau (3.3% → 3.4%) and year-ahead 4.0% → 4.6%; DOL claims at 197,000; and H.4.1 reserve balances down on own manual review, full weekly refreshes being categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority — the owner's own direct review and stamp is exactly the process that exclusion was never delivered (no render, selfcheck, archive or commit) and is superseded above; its evidence was re-verified and held up.** · Prior: Updated & Re-verified September 18, 2026 (LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-18\_draft, this version) revision already drives this window's read in the current committed set; a Sept 18 Motley Fool piece on the SEP's "most important number" is single-source commentary on already-priced primary data, not stamped Sept 18) · **Updated & Re-verified September 19, 2026 (FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-09-19\_draft: HELD FLAT at 32/30/38/44/58.** Jobless claims fell to 196K for the week of Sept 12 (released Sept 15, primary), but the hawkish read, not new information. Housing data cooled modestly (starts -2.6% m/m, permits -2.7% m/m, existing-home sales -2.0% m/m) but is single-month and internally mixed — insufficient alone to settle near 4.95%. A high-profile political story broke in parallel — Trump publicly pressured the Fed and demanded rates be cut to '1% or less' after Chair Warsh voted with a unanimous FOMC to hike. FULL WEEKLY refresh, categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of the size of the move (here, zero) — LEFT AS DRAFT, AWAITING ALEX'S MANUAL REVIEW.) · Last TRUE committed: 31/29/37/44/58 (LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-22\_draft: HELD FLAT at 31/29/37/44/58. Yield drift, CME FedWatch pricing (effectively single-sourced), and Fed VC Jefferson's plumbing-focused speech were all SEPTEMBER 23, 2026.) · Last TRUE committed: 31/29/37/44/58 (2026-09-23\_draft, auto-stamped Sept 23) · Not Financial Advice · **Updated & Re-verified September 24, 2026 (LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-24\_draft, this version) commit followed; superseded by the September 26 weekly refresh above]: RE-RATED DOWN, 31/29/37/44/58 → 29/27/36/44/58.** Fed Governor Michael S. Barr, Sept 23, PRIMARY — the speech P policy adjustments are likely to be needed to ensure inflation comes down to target in a timely fashion", with "risks to achieving our inflation target have increased, while risks to the labor market have re growth since July 2021 (composite 58.4, manufacturing 57.0, services 58.7) alongside the fastest input-cost inflation since October 2022 and selling-price inflation turning back up. Two points off 1mo/3m 5.104% is a market price, reported not scored — and not primary-confirmed, since FRED DGS10 publishes a day late and still read 4.96% for Sept 22 at research time.) · Last TRUE committed: **31/29/37/44/58** committed, its cycle having been abandoned before delivery (2026-09-24\_draft, auto-stamped Sept 24)



|          |    |     |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |   |
|----------|----|-----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|---|
|          |    |     |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |   |
| 6 months | 46 | ... | 48 | 46 | 45 | 45 | 43 | 43 | 43 | 43 | 43 | 44 | 44 | 44 | 42 | 38 | 38 | 38 | 37 | 3 |
| 1 year   | 54 | ... | 56 | 55 | 55 | 55 | 54 | 54 | 54 | 54 | 54 | 54 | 54 | 54 | 54 | 44 | 44 | 44 | 44 | 4 |
| 3 years  | 61 | ... | 62 | 61 | 61 | 61 | 60 | 60 | 60 | 60 | 60 | 60 | 60 | 60 | 60 | 58 | 58 | 58 | 58 | 5 |

**Prior committed P (2026-09-22\_draft, light daily touch, AUTO-STAMPED):** 31 / 29 / 37 / 44 / 58 · **Prior committed P (2026-09-23\_draft, light daily touch, AUTO-STAMPED, HELD FLAT):** 31 / 29 / 37 / 44 / 58 · **Current P (2026-09-23\_draft, light daily touch, AUTO-STAMPED, HELD FLAT):** 36 / 44 / 58 · **Weight:** 20% (equal) · **Impact:** 8 (uniform) · **Formula:** Signal = ((P – 50) ÷ 50) × Quality × Impact. This cycle’s move rests on two independent, same-day, Sept 23 developments: Fed Governor Michael S. Barr’s speech at the verbatim “in my base case, further policy adjustments are likely to be needed” alongside “risks to achieving our inflation target have increased, while risks to the labor market have receded”), and the S&P Global flash US PMI (core inflation, 2022 and selling-price inflation turning back up). The 10-year Treasury yield’s 13bp jump to a 19-year-high 5.104% the same day is a MARKET PRICE, reported but not scored — and, stated plainly, not primary-confirmed: FRED DGS10

THE THREE INPUTS, IN PLAIN ENGLISH

- P** — the odds the macro regime is *good for crypto* by then — not “the Fed cuts by then.” Re-rated down this cycle to **29 / 27 / 36 / 44 / 58** from the committed 31 / 29 / 37 / 44 / 58: two points down on the 23 on-the-record guidance toward further tightening (primary, federalreserve.gov) together with the same day’s S&P Global flash PMI, which paired the strongest private-sector growth since 2007 with 36mo windows held — a single month of survey data and one Governor’s base case do not reach the 2027-2028 policy path.
- Quality** — how trustworthy the evidence is. Unchanged this cycle per house rules.
- Impact** — 8 out of 10, the uniform value every pillar now shares in the equal-weight model. Liquidity is the tide; it moves the whole market at once.

**Carried forward, still load-bearing:** July PCE (bea.gov, primary, released Aug 26) printed a modestly hot headline read, +0.2% m/m / 3.7% y/y (0.1pp above consensus), core +0.2% m/m / 3.7% y/y. The cycle, not re-litigated. The Jul 28-29 FOMC minutes' hawkish bloc ran wider than the three named dissenters; the 30-year Treasury yield's 19-year high was substantially a fiscal-deficit story, not rates from.

## The Claim

*The thesis, and where I differ from the consensus — updated September 26, 2026 (FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-09-26\_draft3, committed by Alex September 27, 2026)*

**This cycle (Sept 22):** the crowd will likely read the Philadelphia Fed and NY Fed Empire State surveys by their falling headline-activity numbers — both surveys' general-conditions readings cooled past the headline to what the Fed itself watches for its own inflation read — both surveys' prices-paid and prices-received sub-indexes jumped, not fell, with Empire State prices paid hitting the high pipeline landing barely a week after the Sept 16 hike and hawkish dot plot, and two independent Fed district banks' own primary surveys pointing the same direction clears this pillar's sufficiency (employment, future activity) fell in the same reports, and the CLARITY/Iran/Tokenization pillars are untouched this cycle — this is a single targeted follow-up, not a fresh weekly sweep. **P RE-RATE** 12mo/36mo held, since two regional sentiment surveys don't speak to the multi-year policy path.

**Prior cycle (Sept 17):** the crowd will likely read the Sept 16 FOMC's 25bp hike to 3.75%-4.00% itself as the headline event. **Me:** that hike was ~92.5% priced into market odds beforehand, so its new fact is the SEP/dot plot — a primary Fed document, not a market price — showing 16 of 18 officials expecting at least one more 2026 hike (12 of 18 specifically pencil in a year-end move to 4.125% or more), shrug (ticked up toward \$76,300, then drifted back to hold near \$76,000-198) — the market had this priced too, but the committee's own forward path is incrementally more hawkish than the odds. **32/31/42/54/60** — 1mo 34→32, 3mo 33→31, 6mo 44→42, concentrated on the windows bracketing the confirmed additional-hike path into Q1 2027; 12mo/36mo held, since the longer-run dot plot is flat.

**Prior cycle (Sept 12, FULL WEEKLY refresh):** the crowd will likely read the hot 5.4% y/y August PPI headline (BLS, Sept 10) — the highest of 2026 — as confirmation the inflation picture is worse than more than three-quarters of the monthly gain is energy (diesel fuel +24.1% alone), and the core reading the Fed actually steers on came in under consensus, a mild disinflationary surprise. That release is more than contradicting it — a fresh, primary-sourced, sufficiency-qualified release that is nonetheless not a distinct new directional catalyst. Independently re-verified the CPI print itself this cycle too, the meeting has not yet occurred and remains the next real catalyst. This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, so — regardless of the flat finding — it is left as DRAFT for Alex's manual review, not auto-stamped.

**Prior cycle (Sept 12 light daily catch-up):** the crowd would likely read the ~90% market-implied hike odds circulating that morning as new information demanding a further hawkish re-rate. **Me:** market numbers don't improve, we have work to do", not a fresh Sept 11-12 statement — it was the market's own reaction to a CPI print this pillar already scored, not a new dated primary fact, so per the dot plot. **34/33/44/54/60**, AUTO-STAMPED.

**Prior cycle (Sept 11):** the crowd will take a headline that jumped from +0.1% to +0.4% m/m and read it as inflation re-accelerating into a hawkish FOMC. **Me:** look at what moved it — energy +2.4% m/m, Iran/Hormuz oil shock showing up in the price index, not broad domestic re-acceleration. The part the Fed actually steers on, core, came in at +0.3% m/m against a +0.4% consensus, with core y/y at +0.3% m/m. Sept 15-16 meeting, and it is why this pillar moves up two points at 1mo/3mo and one at 6mo rather than staying put — and why it does not move at all at 1yr/3yr. It only partly offsets the Sept 15-16 meeting.

**The crowd:** might read Warsh's studied refusal to commit to forward guidance as him keeping his options open, and treat the hawkish framing as just rhetoric until an actual vote. The abandoned move — understated how far the market itself actually moved.

**Me:** now at 32/31/43/54/60, down from the 36/35/45/55/61 this pillar held through Aug 29-Sept 3. That Aug 29 cycle's dedicated adversarial-verification pass re-pulled the CME FedWatch data on the Fed's own odds to not 45.7% — a materially bigger repricing, now past coin-flip. Three light daily checks (Aug 31, Sept 1, Sept 2) found only continued/drifted odds, not a fresh primary print, so P held; a Sept 3 check (released Sept 4) beat sharply — nonfarm payrolls +162,000 vs. ~53-55,000 consensus, unemployment steady at 4.1% — and markets repriced Sept 15-16 FOMC hike odds higher off of it, corroborated by modest equity selloff, and BTC falling ~2% same-day (\$81,265.00 → \$79,676.60). This is a fresh, dated, primary-sourced print — not odds drift — so it clears the sufficiency bar for a further modest move.

**Sept 10** (five further light daily checks) found no new Fed speech or primary data release, so P held flat at 32/31/43/54/60 through Sept 10; the August PPI print (BLS, primary, released Sept 10) showed a reading of 2026 — corroborated across CNBC, Yahoo Finance, UPI, and The Washington Times, logged as context for the CPI print due the next morning but not itself used to move P (the sufficient moving PPI). **Sept 11:** the August CPI print (BLS, primary, released 8:30am ET) landed with headline in line and core a tenth cooler than consensus — see This Cycle above — moving P up to 34/33/44/54/60. **Sept 12, FULL WEEKLY refresh (afternoon, this version):** the August PPI print (BLS, Sept 10) examined the headline and core — reinforces rather than contradicts the CPI read and does not move P; the CPI print was independently re-verified with no discrepancy. P HELD FLAT at 34/33/44/54/60, left as DRAFT for auto-stamp authority. The Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting has not yet occurred and remains the next dated catalyst.

**My edge:** the discipline is in re-pulling the actual rate-odds venue rather than trusting the first number that circulates — this cycle that discipline caught a real error before it was ever delivered to the counter-case since early August, looks less like an outlier with each hawkish print. The August CPI print — due today and still pending as of this research pass — and the Sept 15 FOMC itself remain to be seen. This re-rate prices in a repriced risk, not a foregone decision.

## The Facts

*As of October 3, 2026 (FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-10-03\_draft, LEFT AS DRAFT). Every figure below was independently re-derived from a primary source in this cycle's adversarial-verification pass unless explicitly labelled otherwise.*

### ★ NEW THIS CYCLE — THE WEEK OF SEPTEMBER 26 – OCTOBER 3, 2026

★ **PRIMARY — August PCE undershot, BEA, released Sept 30, 2026.** Every element re-confirmed exact against bea.gov: headline PCE price index **+0.3% m/m and 3.4% y/y; core +0.2% m/m and 3.4% y/y**. The real PCE +0.6%. Both headline and core came in *under* consensus — the headline survey figure was about 3.7%. **Caveat stated rather than buried:** this release embeds the *annual update of the price index*, which is a genuine qualification on the level. Consensus figures are survey expectations, not institutional estimates; BEA publishes none.

★ **PRIMARY — the September jobs report, BLS, released Oct 2, 2026 at 8:30 a.m. ET, and it contradicts the Fed's own stated rationale.** Nonfarm payrolls **+29,000** against an ~84,000 consensus, independently confirmed via FRED UNRATE; average hourly earnings +5 cents / **+0.1% m/m to \$37.81** and **+3.0% y/y**; participation 61.8%. Prior months revised down by a combined **60,000** (Sept 15-16: +133,000 (–29,000); the arithmetic checks. **Three days earlier Governor Barr had said “risks to the labor market have receded.”** This is the single most important new fact on this page.

★ **PRIMARY — Vice Chair Philip N. Jefferson, “The U.S. Economy and Monetary Policy,” Darden School of Business, University of Virginia, Oct 1, 2026.** Quote re-verified verbatim and confirmed by *own judgment, which may take more time.* He added that “any future adjustments in policy should be determined by carefully examining trends in the data, the evolving outlook, and the balance of risks.” A secondary article placing this speech on Sept 30 is wrong — the Board's own calendar puts it Oct 1, and Sept 30 was a Wednesday; the same article attributes a Richmond Fed rural-America press conference on Sept 30. Both are corroboration at best and are excluded from the re-rate.

★ **THE HAWKISH COUNTERWEIGHTS, which are why this move is single-digit and stops at 12 months. (a) Governor Michael S. Barr, “Economic Conditions and Monetary Policy,” Darden School of Business, University of Virginia, Oct 1, 2026.** *“In my base case, further policy adjustments are likely to be needed to ensure inflation comes down to target in a timely fashion.” and “Risks to achieving our inflation target have increased, while the balance of risks remains better positioned than it was a few months ago.”* Correction to an earlier pass of this cycle, which truncated the latter two sentences while presenting them as verbatim: the full endings are restored above. **Critically, Barr spoke on Sept 29 — before the Sept 30 release, and in a response to either.** The September FOMC statement confirms the hike: “The Committee decided to raise the target range for the federal funds rate by 1/4 percentage point to 3-3/4 to 4 percent.” **28 and Dec 8–9. (b) Q2 GDP third estimate, BEA, Sept 30:** real GDP revised **UP to 2.2%** annualized from 1.5% (+0.7pp), real GDI +2.6% (+0.4pp), the GDP/GDI average +2.4% (+0.6pp). Growth (PRIMARY, DOL, released Oct 1, extracted from the release text): **197,000**, –1,000 w/w; prior week revised up 197,000 → 198,000; 4-week average 200,000, –2,500 (prior average revised 202,250) → 5.24% → 5.26% → **5.29% (Sept 30)** → 5.24% (Oct 1), the series ending Oct 1 — there is no Oct 2 observation and none is asserted; a widely circulated “5.27% on Oct 2” traces to a third-party source (Sept 28) → 4.89% (Sept 29) → 4.88% (Sept 30) → **4.78% (Oct 1). A falling 2-year against a rising 10-year is a steepening** — less near-term tightening priced, *more* long-run inflation risk — the Fed's own odds are flat.

**CORRECTED this cycle, and it kills a claim this system has been repeating: jobless claims are NOT at or near a 57-year low.** The “near 57-year lows” / “lowest since 1969” framing carried over from the 2020 cycle, since “language at all — the strings “lowest” and “1969” do not appear in it — and **FRED ICSA refutes it outright:** 197,000 is not even 2026's lowest print, with **189,000** (week of Jul 18) and **195,000** in Jan 2024; the series minimum is 162,000 (Nov 1968). **The level still does the analytical work without the superlative:** claims near 197–200k mean layoffs are not rising, so +29,000 new jobs does not force the Fed's hand.

**MARKET PRICES, never blended with the SEP.** CME FedWatch October-hike odds collapsed to roughly **17–23%** (hold ~77–81%) as of Oct 2, from about 36% a week earlier. For December, odds are 66.2% and 65% — **corrected down from a first-pass “above 75%,” which verification found unsupported;** CME's own page and the CNBC article both returned HTTP 403, so this rests on market prices, not institutional estimates.

**H.4.1, week ended Sept 30** (PRIMARY, released Oct 1, re-confirmed exact): reserve balances **\$2,948,090M** from \$2,930,193M, **+\$17,897M w/w** — last cycle's record –\$83,601M drain has reconciles exactly with what the Sept 26 cycle logged — a clean cross-check.

#### ★ NEW THIS CYCLE — THE WEEK OF SEPTEMBER 19–26, 2026

★ **PRIMARY — Fed Governor Michael S. Barr, "A Long-Term View on the Costs of Shelter," Sept 23, 2026, 10:05 a.m. EDT**, at the Chicago Fed's Housing Affordability 2026 summit. All the [federalreserve.gov/newsevents/speech/files/barr20260923a.pdf](https://www.federalreserve.gov/newsevents/speech/files/barr20260923a.pdf), in one continuous paragraph on p.2: "Economic growth is strong and the labor market is solid, but inflation is above our 2 percent target. ... Inflation has been rising since the start of the year, and we need to take action to bring it back to target. ... **Inflation comes down to target in a timely fashion.**" He also confirmed he supported the Sept 16 hike. *Verification note, stated because it cuts against an earlier draft of this very cycle:* a first draft at 10:00 a.m.; both "corrections" were WRONG and are withdrawn. The sentence is present, and the Board's own September calendar lists Barr at 10:05 a.m. — 10:20 a.m. that day was Vice Chair Jefferson

★ **PRIMARY — S&P Global flash US PMI, Sept 23, 2026.** The embargoed release ("Embargoed until 0945 EDT ... 23 September 2026") was retrieved directly. Composite output **58.4** (from 57.9, vs 53.6 expected); services **58.7**. Critically for this pillar, the release places **input-cost inflation at its fastest since OCTOBER 2022**, attributing it to higher fuel and transport costs. *Figure deliberately not quoted:* an "input prices index 66.4 from 59.9" reading circulated in secondary coverage does NOT appear anywhere in the release and is vendor/subscriber data, so it is not a pillar, is primary.

★ **PRIMARY — University of Michigan Surveys of Consumers, FINAL September, released Sept 25, 2026.** Sentiment **48.1**, down 7.0% month-on-month from 51.7; current conditions 50.9. Ahead inflation expectations jumped from 4.0% last month to 4.6% this month" and "**Long-run inflation expectations ticked up to 3.4%, ending three consecutive months at 3.3%.**" The long-run de-anchored long-run expectations are what extend a tightening cycle beyond one meeting — and it is the specific reason the 6-month window took –3 rather than –1.

★ **PRIMARY — DOL initial jobless claims, week ended Sept 19, 2026:** advance figure **197,000** (the "near 57-year lows" characterisation carried here was later found FALSE and is withdrawn). **198,000**, and the 4-week moving average is **202,250**. Both revisions correct figures this report had been carrying. A near-record-low layoff rate removes the last dovish counterweight to a full

★ **PRIMARY — Federal Reserve H.4.1, week ended Sept 23, 2026.** Reserve balances **\$2,930,193M against \$3,013,794M** the prior week — a fall of exactly **\$83,601M in one week**, arithmetic difference of \$977,084M and total assets roughly flat at \$6,747,704M. This is by far the largest one-week reserve drain this report has logged (prior logged weeks: –\$10.4B, –\$49.3B) and is a direct liquidity drain, not a date rebuild rather than policy tightening, which is why it supports the move without driving it.

**Two Fed voices, both DOWNGRADED on sourcing after verification — used as corroboration only, neither able to move P alone.** *Boston Fed President Susan Collins, Sept 22:* the quote "which inflation remains notably above 2%" — but it was a LinkedIn post that is unfetchable, bostonfed.org does not carry it, and every corroborating outlet traces to the same Reuters story, so no prior cycle — a genuine coverage gap, now closed. *NY Fed President John Williams, Sept 24, at NIESR's London Macro Policy Forum:* **materially recharacterised, because an earlier pass market pricing suggested "it's likely that another rate hike may be appropriate by the end of the year,"** and then adding "That seems to me a reasonable way of thinking about it. **But we have to see.**" The Fed's pricing is exactly the market-expectation-versus-official-estimate conflation this system forbids. No primary transcript exists (it was an unscripted fireside chat; newyorkfed.org 404s), and genuinely is the identical Reuters wire.

**Also logged this cycle, not scoreable.** The Fed's own *Senior Credit Officer Opinion Survey* (Sept 24, primary) reports dealer pricing and non-pricing terms "remained basically unchanged, on a year-on-year basis" — unchanged — not a rate-path signal. Census *New Residential Sales* for August (Sept 24) came in at **684,000 SAAR, an increase**, attributed to price reductions — which **contradicts this report's finding of a price increase** **softened accordingly** (figure is secondary-sourced; the Census PDF would not parse). Census advance durable goods for August (Sept 25) were virtually unchanged at \$338.6B. No Fed speech for Sept 28.

**MARKET PRICES — reported, and never blended with the SEP's institutional estimates.** The 10-year Treasury yield rose **4.96% (Sept 22) → 5.11% (Sept 23) → 5.18% (Sept 24)**, the highest since the 2007-2008 crisis, and the US Treasury's own daily yield-curve series agree exactly on both values. That *resolves* the honest caveat carried in the abandoned Sept 24 draft (FRED had not yet published Sept 23 at the time) — the primary constant-maturity close. The 2-year is quoted at 4.947%, the highest since May 2024 (secondary). CME FedWatch odds of an Oct 27–28 hike moved ~53% (Sept 23) → **77.5% (Sept 24)**, **four more hikes by the June 2027 meeting**, which contradicts and retires this report's earlier "Polymarket ~51% odds of a cut by June 2027" line. *A claimed data-integrity finding was RETRACTED* — endpoint returns September 2026 values ~125bp too low. Verification could not reproduce it — that file truncates long before 2026, so the readings were almost certainly fabricated by a sum of unresolved gap and is not presented as a finding. The 5.11/5.18 values are unaffected.

**RE-CONFIRMED FROM PRIMARY — the Sept 16 FOMC and its dot plot.** The statement reads "The Committee decided to raise the target range for the federal funds rate by 1/4 percentage point to 5.00% to 5.25%." That **eighteen participants** submitted projections, splitting for 2026 year-end **2 at 3.875%, 12 at 4.125%, 4 at 4.375%**; medians 4.1% (2026), 4.1% (2027), 3.9% (2028), 3.2% longer-run. So the 2026-2028 path of 18 at exactly one more — is **correct as written** and survives re-verification.

**THE TEST HAS LANDED, AND IT CAME BACK TWO-SIDED.** August PCE and the Q2 GDP third estimate released **Sept 30** (BEA, primary). Core PCE printed 3.0% y/y, but roughly 0.15-0.2 point below the 3.0% target, rather than fresh disinflation; Q2 GDP was revised sharply up to +2.2%, a genuine growth beat. The two roughly offset, so this pillar's own flip line resolves without confirming or reversing the

- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle — Philadelphia Fed Manufacturing Business Outlook Survey, released Sept 17, 2026 (primary source page confirmed at philadelphiafed.org; that month's PDF did not confirm the release date plus 5+ independent outlets reporting identical figures — MarketScreener, NAM, investinglive, Kitco, Bitget, Academic Capital):** general activity fell to 37.9 (reporting higher prices vs. 1.9% lower) and **prices received rose to 31.3 from 17.7** — a re-acceleration in the inflation-pipeline reading. Employment fell sharply (11.8 from 27.9) and future activity fell to 37.9 (reporting higher prices vs. 1.9% lower) and **prices received rose to 31.3 from 17.7**, a three-month high.
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle — New York Fed Empire State Manufacturing Survey, released Sept 15, 2026 (PRIMARY, fetched directly from newyorkfed.org):** general business conditions cooled to 47.8 (since July 2022 — and **prices received rose to 28.1 from 23.1**, a three-month high).
- **Why this clears the sufficiency bar:** two independent Federal Reserve district banks' own primary surveys, dated the same week, showing the same directional signal (headline activity cooling in year highs) — 2+ independent primary sources in the same input class, not a single-source claim.
- **Why only one point:** both are soft/sentiment surveys, not hard CPI/PCE prints; both releases' own headline-activity and forward-looking components (employment, future activity, general conditions) market pricing actually turned risk-on into Sept 18-19 (10-year backed off its 5.04% high to ~4.95%, BTC recovered) — a market price, not scored, but the honest reason not to take this further.
- **12mo/36mo HELD** — two regional sentiment surveys say nothing about the 2027-2028 policy path those windows price.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN one point on the three near windows, 32/30/38/44/58 → 31/29/37/44/58.** Research capability fully available this cycle (WebSearch clean; WebFetch clean; refresh, and the sourcing clears the sufficiency rule — **AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."**

Carried forward from the September 19 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-19, draft, still draft, awaiting Alex's review), still load-bearing:

- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle — initial jobless claims, week ended Sept 12 (DOL, primary, released Sept 17):** **196,000**, the lowest since mid-July; four-week average 203,250; continuing claims 1.730M (17 hawkish re-rate — confirmatory, not new information, and not independently trigger-worthy on its own).
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle — new-residential-construction data (Census Bureau/HUD, primary, released Sept 17):** housing starts **1,275K SAAR (~2.6% m/m)**, permits **1.394M (~2.7% m/m)**, median price \$429,100 (+1.6%). A genuine rate-sensitive-sector cooling signal, but single-month and internally mixed (single-family starts actually +7.6%) — insufficient alone to move P per the
- ★ **NEW this cycle, background color — University of Michigan preliminary September consumer sentiment (released ~Sept 11-12, primary/academic survey):** fell to **47.8 from 51.7**, predates the current baseline's known-history cutoff and is added here as context even though it doesn't move P now — it is already implicitly reflected in the mood behind the Sept 16-17 hawkish
- **Treasury yields backed up further into and through FOMC week:** the 10-year touched ~5.04% intraweek, a 19-year high, before settling near 4.94-4.95% by Sept 18 as oil prices eased; 2-5-year yields rose to 4.94-4.95% — logged, not scored.
- **CME FedWatch (market price, not scored):** the October 27-28 FOMC meeting priced a **55.1% probability of another 25bp hike** as of Sept 17, 2026 — compare pre-Sept-16-meeting pricing of a hike at roughly 89-94%/54% respectively pre-decision, and Polymarket priced a cut by the June 2027 meeting at roughly 51%.
- **A high-profile political story broke in parallel: President Trump and senior administration officials (the Vice President, the Treasury Secretary, and an economic counselor) publicly** after Chair Warsh nonetheless voted with a unanimous FOMC (12-0) to hike. Well-corroborated across 8+ independent outlets (CNBC, CNN, NBC News, MS NOW, BNN Bloomberg, Fortune, TIME) evidence — the Fed didn't capitulate, if anything this reinforces the hawkish path holding — logged, not scored.

- **Bank-forecaster reactions, logged not scored:** Goldman Sachs's post-meeting note expects an October hike with no December hike in its base case; an earlier BoFA call for three 2026 hikes unchanged earlier this month") and is treated as likely stale/superseded if cited elsewhere. Single-house forecasts reacting to the already-priced SEP, not new primary facts.
- **Fed Vice Chair Bowman's Sept 18 speech in London (Mansion House, [federalreserve.gov](https://www.federalreserve.gov), primary)** covered bank stress-testing rule finalization — not a monetary-policy or rate signal, not a new primary fact.
- **Score decision: P HELD FLAT at 32/30/38/44/58.** Full independent primary-source research this cycle (~15 targeted WebSearches, no capability degradation); nothing above clears the sufficient threshold for a new primary fact. Delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of finding — **LEFT AS DRAFT for Alex's manual review.**

Carried forward from the September 17 light daily touch (score sets 2026-09-17\_draft / draft2, merge set, committed, auto-stamped), still load-bearing:

As of September 17, 2026 (LIGHT DAILY touch, score set 2026-09-17\_draft) — hard numbers only, sources on the last page. New this cycle: the Sept 16 FOMC decision and its SEP/dot plot; the Sept 12 weekly-refresh material further covered in full in the Iran War Risk pillar report.

- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle — Sept 16 FOMC decision ([federalreserve.gov](https://www.federalreserve.gov), primary; corroborated by CNBC, Reuters/Advisor Perspectives, Coinpedia, coingape — 5+ independent outlets).** The first hike in three years. The move itself was ~92.5% priced into CME/market odds beforehand — a market price, not used to move P on its own.
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle — the Summary of Economic Projections / dot plot ([federalreserve.gov](https://www.federalreserve.gov), primary).** 16 of 18 participants project at least one more 2026 rate increase; 12 of 18 specifically drifting down in 2027-2028, but on a slower, more cautious path than previously projected, with the long-run neutral-rate dots clustering tightly at 3.0%. This is a primary Fed institutional document.
- **Bitcoin's reaction was muted:** ticked up toward \$76,300 on the statement, then drifted back to hold near \$76,000-198 through Chair Warsh's press conference (CNBC, Coinpedia) — consistent with plot's forward path, not the decision itself.
- **Score decision: P RE-RATED DOWN, modestly, to 32/31/42/54/60** — 1mo 34→32, 3mo 33→31, 6mo 44→42; 12mo/36mo HELD FLAT at 54/60. Light daily touch, master call band unchanged.
- ★ **Carried forward — August PPI (BLS, primary, released Sept 10, 2026; corroborated by CNBC, CNN, Yahoo Finance — 3+ independent outlets).** Headline final demand **+0.4% m/m** (inflation) more than three-quarters of the monthly gain is attributable to volatile energy costs (diesel fuel +24.1% alone). Core PPI (ex food/energy) came in at **+0.3% m/m**, UNDER consensus on one more surprise on the core reading.
- **Score-relevant read on the PPI print:** reinforces, rather than contradicts, the already-priced "cooler than consensus" August CPI narrative — **not a distinct new directional catalyst**, so it does not move P (BLS primary + 3 independent corroborating outlets).
- **Re-verified August CPI (BLS, released Sept 11) independently this cycle:** headline +0.4% m/m / +3.4% y/y, core +0.3% m/m / +2.4% y/y, shelter +0.3% m/m / +3.0% y/y — matches the final print.
- **DOL initial jobless claims, week ending Sept 5 (released ~Sept 11, primary): 206,000, down 1,000 w/w, 4-week average 206,000** — steady, unremarkable, no signal.
- **CME FedWatch-tracked market-implied odds of a 25bp hike at the Sept 15-16 FOMC read ~62-69% this week (as of Sept 10-11)** — a *market price* only, not an institutional estimate, ex ante ~90% figure referenced in the prior (this morning's) daily cycle's background note — both are reported as market-price snapshots at different times; the divergence is noted, not resolved or resolved.
- **Fed Chair Warsh: no new substantive remarks since the Aug 28 Jackson Hole speech.** A Sept 9 Marketplace piece characterizing him as withholding forward guidance ahead of the meeting was flagged as single-source, does not move P.
- **The Sept 15-16, 2026 FOMC meeting had NOT yet occurred** as of the Sept 12 research pass — it has since occurred and fired; see the NEW facts above.
- **Historical score decision (Sept 12 cycle, superseded):** P HELD FLAT at 34/33/44/54/60 — FULL WEEKLY REFRESH, left as DRAFT for Alex's manual review at the time (weekly refreshes are carried forward; the set was later committed by Alex, and Sept 16 held it flat again before this cycle's re-rate above.

Carried forward from the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-12\_draft, auto-stamped that morning), still load-bearing:

- **Re-checked — no new Fed speech or primary data release found since the Sept 11 CPI print.** Coverage of ~90% market-implied hike odds circulating that morning traced to Fed Chair Warsh's market price, not used to move P. P HELD FLAT at 34/33/44/54/60, AUTO-STAMPED.
- ★ **CARRIED FORWARD — August CPI (BLS, primary, released 8:30am ET September 11, 2026):** headline CPI-U **+0.4% m/m seasonally adjusted** after +0.1% in July, **+3.4% y/y NSA**. Core CPI **+2.1% m/m**, gasoline **+3.9%** — over a third of the monthly increase — shelter **+0.3%**. Fetched directly from bls.gov and re-fetched to confirm.
- **CARRIED FORWARD — versus consensus:** pre-print expectations circulating were headline +0.4% m/m / 3.4% y/y and core +0.4% m/m / 2.4% y/y. **Headline landed exactly in line; core came in below** — used here only to characterise the surprise.
- **Market-implied September hike odds around the print read ~70% for a 25bp move** — a *market price*, not an institutional estimate, reported for context and explicitly not used to move P.
- **Data-hygiene note, logged:** several aggregator summaries of this print published within minutes carried figures inconsistent with the BLS release (for example a 3.1% core y/y). They were discarded; the primary-source rule exists for.

Carried forward from the September 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-05\_draft2), still load-bearing:

- ★ ★ **NEW — August jobs report (BLS, primary, released Sept 4): nonfarm payrolls +162,000 vs. ~53-55,000 consensus; unemployment steady at 4.1%.** A sharp upside beat, corroborated by hourly earnings +\$0.10 (+0.3% m/m, +3.1% y/y).
- ★ ★ **NEW — markets repriced September 15-16 FOMC hike odds higher off the jobs beat.** Point estimates vary by source/timestamp (roughly 60-66% hike probability cited across CNBC, FOMC, etc.) but are directionally consistent and higher than the "~60% hold" framing this pillar's Sept 2 baseline used — i.e. the market moved further toward pricing a hike, not away from it. Fed officials remain in the same position; he'd lean toward holding if inflation data improves. Market commentary (Morgan Stanley-style framing, echoed across outlets) now flags the Sept 11 CPI print as the likely deciding data point.
- ★ ★ **NEW — same-day market reaction, Sept 4 (multi-source corroborated): 2-year Treasury yield +5.3bp to its highest level since January 2025; Dow -271.86 pts (-0.51%) to 53,414.2.**
- **BTC fell ~2% same-day: \$81,265.00 (Sept 3 close) → \$79,676.60 (Sept 4 close)** (data/btc\_usd\_daily.csv) — consistent with a hawkish-surprise risk-off reaction; BTC \$79,646.11 Sept 5.
- **Score decision:** this is a fresh, dated, primary-sourced print (not odds drift alone), sized comparably to the Aug 22→28 catch-up cut for a comparable single dated catalyst — P re-rated down from 32 to 31, more than 8 points versus the last committed baseline.

Carried forward from the Sept 3 light daily catch-up (no new score set — nothing material found on any pillar that cycle):

- **Re-checked CME FedWatch and the H.4.1/data calendar; found no fresh primary print or news event dated Sept 2-3.** config/scores.json untouched; run.py blend re-run against fresh q

Carried forward from the Sept 2 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-02\_draft, still load-bearing):

- **No new H.4.1 or data print found dated Sept 1-2.** September 15-16 FOMC market pricing (CME FedWatch roughly 60% hold) continued the same post-Jackson-Hole drift already priced into this pillar's own standing discipline against chasing odds drift, it did not independently move P.
- **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2** — down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 (Bitstamp) — a real pullback, but driven by the Iran War Risk escalation covered in that pillar's report, not by anything new.

Carried forward from the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-01\_draft, still load-bearing):

- **CME FedWatch September hike odds read ~66% around 11:40am ET Aug 31** (Forbes/KuCoin), up from the ~60.4% CNBC read already priced into the Aug 31 baseline — the same intraday move.
- **No new H.4.1 or jobless claims release Aug 31-Sept 1** — Aug 31 was Labor Day, a US federal holiday; next H.4.1 is due Sept 3.
- **BTC traded at \$78,038.78 on Sept 1** — down from \$78,447.16 on Aug 31 (Bitstamp).

Carried forward from the Aug 31 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-08-31\_draft, still load-bearing):

- **CME FedWatch September hike odds drifted to ~60.4% by Aug 31** (CNBC Jackson-Hole-analyst-roundup, up from ~56% Friday, Aug 28), continuing the same repricing already sized into the Aug 28 report (market-price drift alone, no fresh primary print or news event).

Carried forward from the Aug 29 full weekly refresh (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Fed Chair Kevin Warsh's first Jackson Hole speech as Chair, Aug 28, 10:00am ET (federalreserve.gov, primary transcript, confirmed verbatim this cycle via direct fetch; corroborated Post direct fetch was blocked 403 this cycle, relied on search-summary only).** Theme: "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy." Exact quote, verified against the transcript: "I do not tell me that underlying trends have meaningfully improved." Also: "We must be confident that underlying inflation is moving to our objective... Otherwise, we have work to do," and "I think the transcript does not contain the literal words "may need to raise rates" — that is a fair, standard journalistic paraphrase used independently by CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Forbes, and Spectrum News. I am using that paraphrase here. This was his 100th day as Chairman (confirmed May 22, 2026 succession).
- ★ **July PCE (bea.gov, primary, released Aug 26): headline +0.2% m/m, 3.7% y/y (0.1pp hot vs. consensus); core +0.2% m/m, 3.3% y/y (in line).** Consumer spending +0.2% m/m (\$36.3B) — Warsh's own remarks the same week, didn't by itself change his read on underlying trends.
- **2-year Treasury yield rose to a roughly one-month high: confirmed +6.6bp to 4.29% intraday-close** (one source cites a peak of +9bp to 4.32%); the 30-year yield eased about 1.5bp; stock prices fell.
- **BTC closed at \$79,613.44 on Aug 28 (Bitstamp)** — this price point is now superseded by today's \$77,666.16 close (Aug 29); see the corrected price-action fact above.

- ★ **The Jul 28-29 FOMC minutes' hawkish bloc runs wider than previously known** ([federalreserve.gov](https://www.federalreserve.gov), primary, published Aug 19; corroborated by CNBC, Quartz, Newsquawk, goldsil for an immediate hike), "several participants" also favored a hike at the meeting, and "many participants assessed that policy tightening would likely be necessary if inflation did not decline." The headline / 3.3% core, "remains elevated." Labor cited: unemployment steady at 4.2% (June), wage growth 3.5% y/y (moderating).
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle — the 30-year Treasury yield hit 5.31-5.33%, a ~19-year high (highest since 2007), around Aug 17-18** (Bloomberg, CNBC, Axios). Driven substantially by fiscal/deficit February estimate — plus heavy long-bond supply, not purely a Fed-hike repricing story, though it compounds optically with the hawkish minutes.
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle — equities sold off Aug 20:** S&P 500 -0.87% to 7,641.16; Dow -703.84 pts (-1.32%) to 52,759.21 (partly a ~9% Walmart-earnings-driven drop, not purely Fed-driven); Nasdaq -1.5% to 14,444.75 and rising long yields. Aug 21 saw a partial recovery.
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle — CME FedWatch (September meeting) independently re-verified directly, cross-venue:** ~68-70% hold probability across multiple contemporaneous reads as of Aug 19 (investing.com 64.7% hold, defirate.com blended 68.3% hold/30.6% hike — essentially UNCHANGED before and after the Aug 19 minutes landed, meaning the market already had the hawkish minutes).
- ★ ★ **DISCARDED — a separately-circulating claim of "93.6% September hike probability" was traced this cycle to a garbled data conflation.** It appears to be Kalshi's JULY meeting hold-estimate, not credible for September and explicitly discarded, not used in this pillar's scoring.
- **Jobless claims week ended Aug 15 (DOL, primary, released Aug 20): 206K, down 6K, vs. 210K consensus; 4-week average 204K.** Confirms the low-layoff, tight-labor trend already in the market (see draft1).
- **Aug 22 score decision (superseded by this cycle):** the hawkish minutes detail and the noisy weak retail-sales print largely offset an already-priced rate-odds market — netted to a wash; P hiked.
- **BTC closed at \$77,266.84 on Aug 22 (Bitstamp)** — vs. \$79,613.44 on Aug 28 and \$77,666.16 on Aug 29 (see this cycle's facts above).

- **No new Fed H.4.1 release since the week ended Aug 19 (federalreserve.gov, primary, published Aug 20):** that remains the current release; the next H.4.1 is due Aug 27. No new CPI (next window — July PPI (released Aug 13) was already known and priced before the Aug 16 baseline.
- **No new public remarks from Chair Warsh between the Jul 29 FOMC press conference and the Aug 28 Jackson Hole speech** (see this cycle's facts above).

- **FOMC minutes from the Jul 28-29 meeting confirm the known 9-3 hold vote and the Hammack/Kashkari/Logan dissent for an immediate 25bp hike.** Inflation risks characterized as “moderate” (oil, steel, electricity). No explicit forward guidance from Chair Warsh. A balance-sheet task-force report will inform future deliberations, but no near-term QT-pace signal was given.
- **Offsetting signal, re-confirmed and expanded this cycle: CME FedWatch showed the odds of a September 16 hold rising to ~65% post-minutes, up from a pre-minutes ~50/50** (New York Fed’s venue re-check (~68-70% hold across five independent sources, Aug 17-22) confirms no further material move off that level, i.e. the market stayed priced for a hold through the minutes’ release).

- **July retail sales (Census Bureau, published Aug 14, primary release): headline -0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% expected, core (ex-auto) -0.2% m/m, still +5.0% y/y.** The first monthly decline in gasoline, electronics, nonstore) with some calendar-effect noise (Amazon Prime Day pulled into June). A genuine but noisy dovish-leaning counter-signal — per this pillar's own house discipline.
- **Recalled for continuity, not re-scored:** the Aug 17 Empire State Manufacturing Survey surged to 20.6 vs. 11.0 consensus, the highest since 2022 — a hot beat cutting against the recent cool pillar's discipline against chasing single prints in either direction, this was not sized into a move.

- **Fed H.4.1, week ended Aug 12 (federalreserve.gov, published 4:30pm ET Aug 13):** reserve balances \$2,944,059M, down \$49,290M w/w; Treasury General Account \$963,950M, up \$1.1B w/w. Fed's balance sheet is still priced into this pillar's recent baselines — confirmed an already-adopted trend, didn't fire a fresh trigger.

- **July CPI (BLS, published Aug 12): headline +0.1% m/m / +3.4% y/y; core +0.2% m/m / +2.5% y/y** — landed cool, exactly in line with consensus, drove the Aug 13 re-rate up.
- **Initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 8 (DOL/ETA, published Aug 13): 209,000 actual vs. 202,000 expected** — a genuine weak-side miss, 8-week high, the second trigger behind the Aug 13 re-rate up.

- **Initial jobless claims for the week ended Aug 6 (published Aug 8): 262,000 actual vs. 263,000 expected** — essentially in line with consensus, noise rather than a surprise.

CoinPicks · October 3, 2026 · Research & Education · Not Financial Advice

- ★ **BLS Employment Situation, July 2026: nonfarm payrolls FELL 23,000** versus a consensus estimate of ~83,000 (WSJ-sourced; a competing 95,000 Barron's-sourced figure is less corroborated (-50,000) and retail trade (-19,000). A direct bls.gov fetch returned a 403 this cycle; the figure is confirmed via convergent CNBC, Yahoo Finance, Kiplinger, and CBS News reporting, all citing the same figure.
- ★ **May and June payrolls revised down a combined 103,000** — confirmed, matches the light draft exactly. (One Forbes-sourced fetch this cycle produced a garbled "-252,000 total" figure that is an unreliable summarization artifact, not a correction.)
- ★ **Unemployment ticked down to 4.1% from 4.2%**, but the labor-force participation rate fell to 61.4% — its lowest level in over five years.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle — average hourly earnings rose just 3.2% y/y**, down from 3.4% in June and now trailing CPI (3.5% June y/y) — real wages softening, a detail the same-day light draft did not capture.
- ★ **★ CORRECTED — CME FedWatch September-hold odds check out at ~56%**, not the light draft's ~60%. Two independent corroborating sources (CBS News, a Forbes-sourced pull) both cite ~60%, a real but less-corroborated, likely later-intraday figure. Kalshi (a prediction market, not CME futures-implied pricing — a different instrument, labeled separately per research discipline) is at ~56%.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle — real forecaster disagreement on magnitude:** Bank of America explicitly called the report "a bit dovish on net" but is **sticking with its call for 75bp of hikes in 2026** (50bp in 2025). It described the labor market as "not loose, not tight" — a measured, non-alarmed read. Morgan Stanley's Ellen Zentner says the **Aug 12 CPI print** — inside this pillar's own 1-month window — is "not too bad".
- ★ **Jobless claims for the week ended Aug 1: 199,000, 4-week average 198,750** — the lowest of this cycle, in real tension with the weak payrolls print. Points to "low-hire, low-fire" stagnation.

Carried forward from Aug 7 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **Fed H.4.1 for the week ended Aug 5 (federalreserve.gov, direct pull):** total assets \$6,748,567M, reserve balances \$2,993,349M — reserves +\$8.78B w/w, TGA -\$3.45B w/w. An unremarkable week.

Carried forward from Jul 30-Aug 5 (still load-bearing):

- ★ **★ CONFIRMED, PRIMARY SOURCE — the FOMC held rates at 3.50-3.75% on Jul 29, 2026, on a 9-3 vote.** Three regional-bank presidents — Beth Hammack (Cleveland), Neel Kashkari (Minneapolis), and Patrick Harker (San Francisco) — all voted "no" (federalreserve.gov statement, corroborated by CNBC, Forbes, Fox Business, TechTimes). This is the **first unified 3-member dissent since September 2016**. No SEP/dot plot this meeting (no data yet).
- ★ **Chair Warsh's press conference was unusually combative and offered no forward guidance:** "there is no soft inflation target... not on this committee's watch"; "the five-plus years of inflation off market reaction followed: S&P 500 fell 1.85% in the final 65 minutes of trading (full day: S&P -1.52%, Dow -2.19%, Nasdaq -1.74%); the 30-year Treasury yield rose to 5.21%, its highest since 2007".
- ★ **★ CONFIRMED, PRIMARY SOURCE — jobless claims for the week ended Jul 25 came in at 197,000** (DOL/ETA release, fetched and read directly), a genuine +9,000 increase; the prior week's primary release itself confirms the seasonal-adjustment distortion flagged last cycle: actual non-seasonally-adjusted claims fell only 9.2% w/w versus the 13.3% seasonal factors expected — more than a reverse, exactly as it did.
- ★ **The September hike-odds figure could not be reconciled to a single number this cycle, despite four direct attempts.** Live pulls produced 55.8% (Fox Business, Jul 28), 62.4% (Investing.com, Southeast AgNet, Jul 30) — no two agree. The qualitative direction — "still elevated, majority-hike-priced" — is the only defensible takeaway; no re-rate rests on a specific point figure.
- ★ **H.4.1 balance sheet: no new release found for the week ended Jul 29** as of this check (normal Thursday-afternoon publication timing); the most recent confirmed release remains Jul 23 (vs. Jul 20 for figures directly confirmed against federalreserve.gov last cycle).
- ★ **Bank of America projects three 25bp hikes in 2026** (to 4.25-4.50%) — single-source (Forbes, citing BofA), flagged not scored.
- ★ **Carried forward, not re-verified this cycle:** June CPI (-0.4% m/m) and PPI (-0.3% m/m), both BLS-primary-confirmed in a prior cycle; Warsh's Jul 14/15 congressional testimony; the June FOMC minutes contradicted by this cycle's findings — the hawkish FOMC outcome sits alongside, not against, the still-intact disinflation trend.
- ★ **The labor market cracked in slow motion, then partially un-cracked this week** — June payrolls +57K vs ~115K consensus (carried forward); this cycle's 197K claims print, while up from 188K, is still below the long-term trend.
- ★ **Policy rate and balance sheet: 3.50-3.75%, next FOMC (with SEP/dot plot) is Sept 15-16, 2026.** Fed communications blackout ended with the Jul 29 meeting; watch for the first round of the SEP/dot plot.
- ★ **BTC closed at \$64,706.50 (Jul 30)** — holding up despite the hawkish FOMC surprise and confirmed equity/bond-market risk-off reaction. **Updated: BTC closed at \$64,661.55 on Aug 5**, essentially flat.

The Prize

Illustrative only — not price targets, not advice

The canonical anchor: **2020-21 ZIRP + QE** ran BTC ~\$3,800 → \$69,044 (~15-18x) — a unique COVID/zero-rate/open-ended-QE setup, not a repeatable base case. The **2024-25 cuts** ran ~\$60K → \$126K (2x) — a real gain that arrived without any Fed-specific catalyst this week (the Sept 16 FOMC hike and hawkish SEP then moved this pillar). From here, a retest of the \$126K high ≈ **+53.6%**.

Discount it hard, twice. First: easing is not an automatic catalyst — the last cycle topped on a non-Fed shock. Second: the Sept 16 hike and its hawkish SEP already reflect a real repricing of near-term inflation (another hike), not a settled path further out — Chair Warsh explicitly declined to submit his own dot or commit to a reaction function, and the Oct 27-28 FOMC is the real next test. A major Fed move longer looks like an outlier after the Sept 16 hike. The Prize doesn't feed the math — it tells you what the 3-year lean is worth acting on when the tide finally turns.

The Other Side

The strongest honest case my re-rate — even the moderated one — is still wrong

- ★ **This re-rate might not be conservative enough a read on BofA's stance.** Bank of America has been calling for 75bp of 2026 hikes since early August, straight through the cool CPI print this cycle. A hike into what's still a mixed data picture, even 36/35 could prove too generous.
- ★ **Warsh explicitly avoided committing to a reaction function — this report may be over-reading a rhetorical signal into a real repricing.** The CME odds move is real, quantified, and novel, but not on new data or a stated threshold; if Warsh was simply managing expectations rather than pre-committing to a September hike, this cycle's move could unwind as fast as it appeared.
- ★ **The adversarial-verification pass caught one error in the abandoned draft's CME figure — it may not have caught all of them.** This cycle corrected 45.7% to the high-50s cluster, but the light draft (read) rather than a single authoritative CME FedWatch screenshot pulled directly by this report; a subsequent, cleaner pull could still move the number again.
- ★ **I may still be over-reacting to one speech and one data print.** This pillar has already seen a claims number ("lowest since 1969") partially reverse the following week on a seasonal-adjustment basis — a hawkish-sounding speech, even a well-corroborated one, could be a similar move that partially unwinds once the actual September data (another CPI, another jobs report) lands.
- ★ **The FOMC's own hawkish dissent hasn't gone away and now looks more, not less, mainstream.** Three regional presidents voted for an immediate hike on Jul 29, and Warsh's Aug 28 remarks in a more ambiguous data picture is a live tension, not resolved by this cycle's move either.
- ★ **Downward revisions can themselves get revised.** The BLS's own benchmark process regularly adjusts prior months; May-June's combined 103,000 downward payroll revision is a real, prima facie case.
- ★ **Weak labor data plus a still-elevated inflation/oil backdrop (Iran-driven, and this cycle's Iran pillar got worse, not better) is stagflation risk, not straightforwardly bullish.** If the Fed's next move is a rate cut, the worst outcome for risk assets than either a clean cut or a clean hold.

The Triggers

Dated events — some prove the claim right, some prove it wrong. **Re-set September 26, 2026 (FULL WEEKLY refresh).** The flip line below is now HALF-MET: three Fed communications (Barr primary-verified, Williams hedged, Collins confirmed), **August PCE and the Q2 GDP third estimate on Sept 30 are the test**, four days out. Historical re-set notes follow: originally re-set August 29, 2026, full weekly refresh.

| DATE                                                                                                 | EVENT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MEANS                                                                                                                     |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>FIRE</b> D Oct 2 — <b>PRIMARY</b> (bls.gov), and it undercuts this pillar’s own hawkish rationale | <b>September payrolls +29,000</b> against an ~84,000 consensus; <b>unemployment up to 4.2%</b> ; average hourly earnings +0.1% m/m and +3.0% y/y; participation 61.8%; and <b>60,000 of downward revisions</b> , with July flipping to ~10,000. <b>Governor Barr had said on Sept 29 that “risks to the labor market have receded”</b> — three days later the data said otherwise. CME FedWatch October-hike odds fell to ~17–23% from ~36% a week earlier ( <i>market prices</i> ). <b>The counterweight, and it matters:</b> initial claims were 197,000, so layoffs are NOT rising — this is a hiring freeze, not a firing wave | <b>RE-RATED UP to 35/29/37%</b>                                                                                           |
| <b>FIRE</b> D Sept 30 — <b>PRIMARY</b> (bea.gov), two releases pulling opposite ways                 | <b>August PCE undershot:</b> headline +0.3% m/m and <b>3.4% y/y</b> against a ~3.7% consensus; <b>core 3.0% y/y</b> ; real PCE +0.6%. Caveat stated: the release embeds the annual update of the National Economic Accounts, revisions back to January 2021. <b>The same day, Q2 GDP was revised sharply UP to 2.2%</b> from 1.5% (+0.7pp), with real GDI +2.6%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Fed & Macro: the dovish leg, more likely than not. 6mo +3                                                                 |
| <b>Checked</b> Oct 1–3 — <b>PRIMARY, and two-sided</b>                                               | <b>Vice Chair Jefferson, Oct 1:</b> “My colleagues and I will need to come to our own judgment, <b>which may take more time</b> ” — a sitting Vice Chair slowing the pace. <b>Against it, the long end:</b> FRED DGS10 reached <b>5.29% on Sept 30</b> while DGS2 fell to 4.78% by Oct 1 — a steepening that prices less near-term tightening and more long-run inflation risk. <b>H.4.1:</b> reserve balances +\$17,897M w/w to \$2,948,090M, reversing last cycle’s record drain                                                                                                                                                 | Corroborates the near-wind point and 36mo none                                                                            |
| <b>CORRECTED</b> Oct 3 — a claim this pillar had been repeating is <b>FALSE</b> and is withdrawn     | <b>Jobless claims are NOT at or near a 57-year low.</b> The DOL release contains no “lowest since” language — the strings “lowest” and “1969” do not appear in it — and FRED ICESA refutes it: 197,000 is not even 2026’s lowest, with 189,000 (Jul 18) and 190,000 (Apr 25) both lower. The series minimum is 162,000, Nov 1968                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | No P move — the <i>level</i> always                                                                                       |
| <b>FIRE</b> D Sept 25 — <b>HAWKISH, PRIMARY, this cycle — the most consequential single figure</b>   | <b>University of Michigan final September survey:</b> year-ahead inflation expectations jumped 4.0% → 4.6%, and <b>LONG-RUN expectations ticked 3.3% → 3.4%, ending three consecutive months at 3.3%.</b> Sentiment fell to 48.1 (–7.0% m/m)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | De-anchoring long-run expectations –3 rather than –1                                                                      |
| <b>FIRE</b> D Sept 24 — <b>HAWKISH, PRIMARY, arithmetic checked</b>                                  | <b>Fed H.4.1, week ended Sept 23:</b> reserve balances \$2,930,193M from \$3,013,794M — <b>–\$83,601M in one week</b> , the largest drain this report has logged — with TGA +\$100,056M                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | A direct liquidity negative for driving it                                                                                |
| <b>FIRE</b> D Sept 24 — <b>HAWKISH-ADJACENT, PRIMARY series</b>                                      | <b>DOL initial jobless claims, week ended Sept 19: 197,000;</b> prior week revised UP to 198,000; 4-week average 202,250                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Removes the last dovish counter                                                                                           |
| <b>FIRE</b> D Sept 23 — <b>HAWKISH, PRIMARY</b> release retrieved                                    | <b>S&amp;P Global flash US PMI:</b> composite 58.4 (strongest since July 2021), manufacturing 57.0, services 58.7 — paired with <b>the fastest input-cost inflation since OCTOBER 2022</b> , attributed to fuel and transport costs. The “66.4 input-prices index” figure in secondary coverage is NOT in the release and is excluded                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Growth beat and cost-push reads it as bearish on the liquid                                                               |
| <b>FIRE</b> D Sept 23 — <b>HAWKISH, PRIMARY, verbatim from the Fed’s own PDF</b>                     | <b>Governor Michael S. Barr, “A Long-Term View on the Costs of Shelter,” 10:05 a.m. EDT:</b> “inflation is above our 2 percent target and not clearly trending toward target in a timely way ... risks to achieving our inflation target have increased, while risks to the labor market have receded ... <b>In my base case, further policy adjustments are likely to be needed.</b> ” All three sentences confirmed by local text extraction; two earlier “corrections” to this item were themselves wrong and are withdrawn                                                                                                     | A sitting Governor who supports bundle, and alone sufficient to                                                           |
| FIRED Sept 22 — hawkish, but DOWNGRADED on sourcing this cycle                                       | <b>Boston Fed President Susan Collins:</b> “I now see an increased likelihood of future scenarios in which inflation remains notably above 2%.” Quote verbatim-confirmed, but it was a LinkedIn post, bostonfed.org does not carry it, and all corroboration traces to one Reuters story — <b>effectively single-agency</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Never scored by any prior cycle                                                                                           |
| FIRED Sept 24 — hawkish, but MATERIALLY RECHARACTERISED                                              | <b>NY Fed President John Williams</b> at NIESR London was <i>describing investors’ forecasts</i> — market pricing made another year-end hike “likely” — then added “That seems to me a reasonable way of thinking about it. <b>But we have to see.</b> ” No primary transcript exists; genuinely independent reporting is TWO outlets, the rest being one Reuters wire                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Corroboration only. Presenting which this system forbids                                                                  |
| <b>RESOLVED</b> Sept 30, 2026 — <b>HARD DATA LANDED, read as two-sided</b>                           | <b>August PCE (core 3.0% y/y, but ~0.15-0.2pt of the apparent cooling is a telegraphed BEA methodology change, not fresh disinflation) and the Q2 GDP third estimate (revised sharply up to +2.2% annualized)</b> — the two offset rather than confirm or reverse the Sept 23-26 hawkish bundle                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Neither clears the sufficiency                                                                                            |
| Watch — October 27–28, 2026 FOMC                                                                     | <b>MARKET PRICES, not institutional estimates:</b> CME FedWatch odds of another 25bp hike moved ~53% (Sept 23) → <b>77.5% (Sept 24)</b> → ~70–76% (Sept 25). Traders price roughly <b>four more hikes by June 2027</b> , which retires this report’s earlier “~51% odds of a cut by June 2027” line                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Confirmation or reversal of the prices                                                                                    |
| Checked Sept 24–26 — <b>NEUTRAL / counter-signal, logged</b>                                         | The Fed’s own <b>SCOOS</b> (Sept 24, primary) shows dealer terms “basically unchanged, on net, across all counterparty types.” Census <b>new home sales rose to 684,000 SAAR</b> in August, and durable goods were virtually unchanged. <b>No Fed speeches Sept 24, 25 or 26</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | The rising home-sales print & than quietly dropped                                                                        |
| FIRED Sept 22 — mildly hawkish, primary, this cycle                                                  | <b>Philadelphia Fed Manufacturing Business Outlook Survey (released Sept 17, philadelphiafed.org primary, 5+ corroborating outlets): prices paid 40.9–48.6, prices received 17.7–31.3, while general activity fell 47.4–37.8 and employment fell 27.9–11.8.</b> New York Fed Empire State Manufacturing Survey (released Sept 15, primary, fetched directly): prices paid 58.1→63.1 (highest since July 2022), prices received 23.1→28.1, while general business conditions fell 20.6→7.6                                                                                                                                          | Two independent Fed district accelerating input costs) — c surveys' own forward components one point. Sourcing clears the |
| Checked Sept 19, no change — confirmatory, FULL WEEKLY refresh                                       | <b>Jobless claims (DOL, primary, released Sept 17): 196,000 for the week ended Sept 12, lowest since mid-July; four-week average 203,250.</b> Housing starts –2.6% m/m, permits –2.7% m/m (Census Bureau/HUD, Sept 17, primary); existing-home sales –2.0% m/m (NAR, Sept 10, primary) — single-month, internally mixed (single-family starts +7.6%)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Confirmatory of the already-for next cycle if the housing g                                                               |
| Watch — October 27-28, 2026 FOMC (next scheduled meeting)                                            | <b>CME FedWatch prices a 55.1% probability of another 25bp hike at the October meeting (as of Sept 17, 2026)</b> — up from 0% cut / 37.6% hold / 62.4% hike priced ahead of the Sept 16 meeting. Polymarket/Kalshi priced the Sept hike at roughly 89-94%/54% pre-decision; Polymarket prices a cut by the June 2027 meeting at roughly 51%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Market price, not an institution                                                                                          |
| Logged Sept 16-19 — governance context, not scored                                                   | <b>President Trump and senior administration officials (the Vice President, the Treasury Secretary, an economic counselor) publicly pressured the Fed against hiking; Trump demanded rates be cut to “1% or less” after Chair Warsh voted with a unanimous FOMC (12-0) to hike anyway.</b> Well-corroborated across 8+ independent outlets (CNBC, CNN, NBC News, MS NOW, BNN Bloomberg, Fortune, The Hill, Bloomberg)                                                                                                                                                                                                              | A governance/Fed-independent reinforces the hawkish path h                                                                |
| Checked Sept 18, no change                                                                           | <b>A Sept 18 Motley Fool piece discusses “the most important number” in the Fed’s Summary of Economic Projections</b> — commentary on the same federalreserve.gov SEP table already cited in the Sept 17 re-rate, single-source, not a new dated fact                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | No P move — held flat at 32,                                                                                              |

|                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| FIREd Sept 16, 2:00pm ET / confirmed Sept 17 — HAWKISH, primary, this cycle                | <b>Sept 16 FOMC: 25bp hike to 3.75%-4.00% (12-0), first hike in 3 years — largely priced (~92.5% CME odds pre-meeting), not scored alone.</b> The SEP/dot plot (federalreserve.gov, primary) shows 16 of 18 officials expecting another 2026 hike, 12 of 18 pencilling in one more 25bp move by year-end to 4.125%; slower 2027-2028 descent projected, neutral rate anchored near 3.0%. Corroborated by CNBC, Reuters/Advisor Perspectives, Coinpedia, coingape. BTC reaction muted (~\$76,300 → drifted back near \$76,000-198). | The rate decision itself doesn't move the market — -2/-2/-2/flat/flat re-rate, con                                                                       |
| FIREd Sept 10, 8:30am ET — HAWKISH, confirmed primary                                      | <b>August PPI (BLS, primary): +0.4% m/m (in line), but +5.4% y/y — the highest 12-month reading of 2026, up from 4.8% in July; core PPI +4.6% y/y (from 4.3%).</b> Corroborated by CNBC, Yahoo Finance, UPI, and The Washington Times. Final-demand energy +4.2% m/m, diesel fuel +24.1% — plausible early pass-through of the Iran-war oil shock (Brent \$106-108/bbl, highest since May 19)                                                                                                                                      | The annual acceleration is the 15-16 FOMC; drove this cycle's                                                                                            |
| FIREd Sept 11, 8:30am ET — resolved (carried forward)                                      | <b>August CPI (BLS, primary):</b> headline +0.4% m/m/3.4% y/y, core +0.3% m/m/2.4% y/y — a tenth cooler than consensus on core                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Drove the Sept 11 1mo/3mo re                                                                                                                             |
| FIREd Sept 4, 8:30am ET — HAWKISH, confirmed primary, this cycle                           | <b>August jobs report (BLS, primary): nonfarm payrolls +162,000 vs. ~53-55,000 consensus, unemployment steady 4.1%.</b> Corroborated by CNBC, Yahoo Finance, TheStreet, U.S. News, Investing.com/Reuters                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Markets repriced Sept 15-16 " ~60% hold" framing); 2yr yield Drove this cycle's -4/-4/-2/-1 daily authority.                                             |
| Checked Sept 3, no change                                                                  | <b>Re-checked CME FedWatch and the H.4.1/data calendar; nothing material found dated Sept 2-3</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | No P move — config/scores,                                                                                                                               |
| Checked Sept 2, no change                                                                  | <b>No new H.4.1 or data print found dated Sept 1-2;</b> September 15-16 FOMC market pricing (CME FedWatch roughly 60% hold) continues the same post-Jackson-Hole drift already priced into the Sept 1 baseline                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Not a fresh data-driven move (War Risk, not this pillar) pen                                                                                             |
| Logged Aug 31, 11:40am ET — drift, not independently trigger-worthy                        | <b>CME FedWatch September hike odds continued drifting to ~66%</b> (Forbes/KuCoin), up from the ~60.4% CNBC read the Aug 31 baseline used                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Same intraday drift sequence was Labor Day, no H.4.1 or cl                                                                                               |
| RESOLVED — Sept 15-16, 2026 (carried forward, see the FIREd row at top)                    | FOMC hiked 25bp as the corrected CME FedWatch read anticipated, with a hawkish SEP/dot plot on top                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | The hike confirmed the repric — see top row                                                                                                              |
| FIREd Aug 28, 10:00am ET — HAWKISH, confirmed primary; CORRECTED this cycle                | <b>Fed Chair Warsh's first Jackson Hole speech as Chair</b> (federalreserve.gov primary, verbatim-confirmed; CNBC, PBS, Reuters/investing.com, CNN, Yahoo Finance): cooler summer PCE/CPI prints "do not tell me that underlying trends have meaningfully improved"; media paraphrase (not a direct quote) that the Fed may need to raise rates; avoided forward guidance/reaction-function otherwise                                                                                                                              | <b>CORRECTED — CME September cycle's adversarial re-pull),</b> pre-speech to a \$79,613.44 c larger than first drafted. Drov excluded regardless of move |
| Fired Aug 27 — mildly hawkish-adjacent, primary, this cycle                                | <b>Initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 22 (DOL primary): 203,000 vs. 208,000 consensus,</b> down from the prior week's revised 207,000; continuing claims 1.778M vs. 1.79M forecast                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Removes a dovish pressure b move                                                                                                                         |
| Fired Aug 26 — routine, primary, this cycle                                                | <b>Fed H.4.1, week ended Aug 26 (federalreserve.gov primary): reserve balances –\$10,351M w/w to \$2,924,936M; TGA –\$2,876M w/w to \$950,736M</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Continuation of the known re                                                                                                                             |
| FIREd Aug 26 — modestly hawkish, primary (carried forward from the abandoned Aug 28 draft) | <b>July PCE (bea.gov primary):</b> headline +0.2% m/m/3.7% y/y (0.1pp hot), core +0.2% m/m/3.3% y/y (in line)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | A real but modest hot print t rate                                                                                                                       |
| Fired Aug 19, 2:00pm ET — confirmed hawkish-but-already-priced (carried forward)           | <b>FOMC minutes (Jul 28-29 meeting), federalreserve.gov primary:</b> hawkish bloc wider than the three named dissenters ("several participants" beyond them favored a hike, "many participants" saw tightening as possibly necessary)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Already reflected in the Aug                                                                                                                             |
| Logged Aug 17-18 (carried forward)                                                         | <b>30-year Treasury yield hit 5.31-5.33%, a ~19-year high</b> — driven substantially by fiscal/deficit concerns, not purely Fed repricing                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Already reflected in the Aug                                                                                                                             |
| Fired Aug 20 (carried forward)                                                             | <b>Equity selloff, partial Aug 21 recovery</b> — attributed to the hawkish minutes and rising long yields                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Already reflected in the Aug                                                                                                                             |
| Fired Aug 20, confirmed Aug 22 (carried forward)                                           | <b>Initial jobless claims, week ended Aug 15: 206K vs. 210K consensus</b> (modest hawkish beat, 4-week average 204K); prior week (Aug 8) revised up to 212K from 209K                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Confirms the low-layoff tren                                                                                                                             |
| Fired Aug 14, logged Aug 16 (carried forward)                                              | <b>July retail sales:</b> headline –0.6% m/m vs. +0.1% expected, core –0.2%, still +5.0% y/y — first decline in nine months, steepest since May 2025, broad-based with some Prime-Day calendar noise                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | A genuine but noisy dovish-l against chasing single prints                                                                                               |
| Fired Aug 13, 4:30pm ET (carried forward)                                                  | <b>Fed H.4.1, week ended Aug 12:</b> reserve balances –\$49,290M w/w to \$2,944,059M, TGA +\$56,626M w/w to \$963,950M                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Directionally the same reserv                                                                                                                            |
| Fired Aug 12-13 (carried forward)                                                          | <b>July CPI landed cool/in-line; jobless claims (week ended Aug 8) missed weak at 209K vs. 202K expected</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Drove the Aug 13 re-rate up                                                                                                                              |
| Fired Aug 7, re-confirmed independently — DOVISH, moderated (carried forward)              | <b>BLS July jobs report:</b> payrolls fell 23,000 vs. ~83,000 expected, unemployment 4.1% on a falling participation rate, May/June revised down a combined 103,000; Sept hold odds rose to ~56%                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Drove the Aug 8 1mo/3mo re                                                                                                                               |
| Fired Jul 29 — HAWKISH, confirmed primary (carried forward)                                | <b>FOMC held 9-3,</b> three regional presidents dissenting for an immediate hike — first unified 3-member dissent since Sept 2016; Bank of America still projects 75bp of 2026 hikes even after the Aug 12 cool CPI                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Still a live tension against thi                                                                                                                         |
| RESOLVED — Sept 15-16, 2026 (carried forward)                                              | FOMC hiked, confirming the corrected, larger hawkish repricing this cycle's Aug 29 re-rate anticipated                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Confirmation, not a surpris                                                                                                                              |
| Ongoing                                                                                    | Iran/Hormuz oil-inflation risk — see Iran War Risk pillar for the current read                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Watch for pass-through into                                                                                                                              |

**The flip line, updated Oct 1 — RESOLVED, and it came back two-sided, not a confirmation.** The test this pillar set for itself was whether “the next hard CPI/PCE/PPI print or FOMC communication confirms the 23-26 bundle (Barr primary-verified and unambiguous, Williams and Collins corroborating). **The hard-data half landed Sept 30: August PCE and the Q2 GDP third estimate.** Core PCE printed 3.0% y/y — but a for roughly 0.15-0.2 points of that apparent cooling, so it is not read as a clean confirmation of disinflation. Q2 GDP was revised sharply up to +2.2% (from 1.5%), a genuine growth beat that argues the opposite d **move in either direction** — so -4/-4/-3/- 1/0 (vs. the Sept 23 baseline) stands as this cycle's read, held flat on the Oct 1 daily touch. A government shutdown was separately averted through Dec 11, removing a growth is strong, layoffs are not rising (claims 197,000), new home sales rose, credit terms are unchanged, and the big reserve drain is mostly mechanical. Next watch: the Oct 27–28 FOMC.

**Prior flip line, Sept 11:** the Aug 13 cool CPI and weak claims print were the last genuine dovish confirmation this pillar found. Since then, the Aug 19 minutes' wider hawkish bloc, Warsh's Jackson Hole words, a h consensus), and now the Sept 10 August PPI report (5.4% y/y headline, a 2026 high) have all pointed the same hawkish direction, with CME/market-implied Sept 15-16 hike odds still cited in the ~56-60% range ac commit to a reaction function, and Fed officials remain publicly split (Warsh hawkish, Waller conditionally dovish). The August CPI print, due today and still pending as of this research pass, is now the next real test confirmation and re-rate down hard. If it holds or cuts despite this cycle's tone and odds move, treat that as evidence the hawkish rhetoric outran the committee, and re-rate back up.

## My Decision

**UPDATED DRAFT — OCTOBER 3, 2026 · AWAITING MY STAMP (2026-10-03\_draft) · FULL WEEKLY REFRESH · THIS PILLAR RE-RATED UP — LARGEST MOVE**

**P (2026-10-03\_draft, FULL WEEKLY refresh, LEFT AS DRAFT — AWAITING ALEX'S STAMP; RE-RATED UP, the largest move this cycle and a direct**  
**(2026-09-26\_draft3, FULL WEEKLY refresh, committed by Alex September 27, 2026): 27 / 25 / 34 / 43 / 58 · Change: +8 / +4 / +3 / +1 / 0 · My**  
**signals: 1mo -2.04 (Bear) · 3mo -2.86 (Bear) · 6mo -1.66 (Bear) · 1yr -0.72 (Mild Bear) · 3yr +0.83 (Mild Bull) · Master (equal-weight), this cycle**  
**3yr +2.82 · THE FINAL NUMBER (this blend): -0.07 equal-weight (Neutral) / +0.48 horizon-weighted (Neutral), versus -0.08 / +0.47 on the SEP**  
**Leave-one-out range: -0.74 to +0.62 (sign still flips) · BTC \$84,858.11 (local run.py quant fetch, Bitstamp; Oct 3, 2026 partial session — the Oct**

**Sept 26 FULL WEEKLY refresh (score set 2026-09-26\_draft3), this version — RE-RATED DOWN, 31/29/37/44/58 → 27/25/34/43/58 (-4/-4/-3/-1/0), the largest move of this cycle.** This is a week  
**and alone sufficient:** Governor Barr's Sept 23 Chicago Fed speech, all three load-bearing sentences confirmed verbatim by local text extraction of the Fed's own PDF — "inflation is above our 2 percent  
inflation target have increased, while risks to the labor market have receded," and "in my base case, further policy adjustments are likely to be needed." **PRIMARY:** the S&P Global flash US PMI, retrieved from  
with the fastest input-cost inflation since October 2022. **PRIMARY:** UMich's final September survey, year-ahead inflation expectations 4.0% → 4.6% and *long-run* 3.3% → 3.4%, breaking three straight months  
**PRIMARY:** H4.1 reserve balances down \$83,601M in one week, the largest drain logged here. **Two Fed voices were downgraded on sourcing rather than leaned on:** Williams was characterising *investor*  
to one Reuters story, so both are corroboration only. **Why this size:** one unambiguous primary-sourced Governor plus hard data on costs, expectations, labour and liquidity moves an October hike from core  
-4/-4/-2/-1/-1 and Aug 28-29 (Warsh) took -7/-6/-3/-1/-1 — so this sits inside the established range for a larger bundle than either. 6mo takes -3 rather than the abandoned Sept 24 draft's -1. *spec*  
survey month and a few speeches say little about H2-2027, and 36mo holds at 58 because nothing dated bears on 2029. **The honest other side, and why the move is single-digit:** growth is strong and the  
new home sales *rose* to 684K SAAR, which contradicts this report's earlier cooling-housing read and is corrected accordingly; the Fed's own SCOOS shows credit terms basically unchanged; and the large re  
**ALEX, September 27, 2026, after his own manual review** — full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp authority regardless of evidence quality or move size, so this went  
August PCE on Sept 30 is the first hard print since any of this, and if it comes in soft this is the first move to revisit.

**Sept 24 draft (score set 2026-09-24\_draft) — WRITTEN BUT NEVER DELIVERED; SUPERSEDED by the Sept 26 weekly above.** It proposed 31/29/37/44/58 → 29/27/36/44/58 and its report edits claim  
followed and config/scores.json was never advanced past draft. It is retained here for the audit trail only. **On re-verification its evidence HELD UP in full** — both claims below are confirmed, and two  
superseded because more evidence landed after it, not because it was mistaken. Its original text follows. Two independent, same-day hawkish developments dated Sept 23, 2026, neither previously scored.  
Affordability 2026 summit (10:05am EDT, Sept 23) — the full text was fetched and parsed directly from `federalreserve.gov` (`barr20260923a.pdf`), not read through an outlet's summary. Verbatim: "Econ  
target and not clearly trending toward target in a timely way. Moreover, risks to achieving our inflation target have increased, while risks to the labor market have receded." And: "In my base case, further po  
timely fashion." A sitting Governor who supported the Sept 16 hike, guiding on the record toward more. **(2) The S&P Global flash US PMI, released Sept 23:** composite output **58.4** (from 56.0), the strong  
expected), strongest since May 2022; services **58.7**. The line that matters here: **input costs rose at their fastest rate since October 2022, and selling-price inflation rose too** — reversing August, when s  
returned HTTP 403 to automated fetch, so those figures are carried on 5+ independent outlets reporting identical values (Newsquawk, investinglive, FXStreet, TradingEconomics, Sharecast, Seeking Alpha);  
is the separate manufacturing *output* index, 57.0 is the headline PMI quoted here. **Why two points and not more:** Barr's remark is largely *consistent with* already-known guidance rather than new informat  
this year — and the PMI's strength is genuinely two-sided for crypto, since strong growth and a solid labor market are risk-on supportive; the bearish channel here is the rate path and liquidity, not the eco  
little about the 2027-2028 path those windows price. **Market prices, reported and explicitly not scored:** the 10-year Treasury yield rose more than 13bp to **5.104%** on Sept 23, a 19-year high and the larg  
(CNBC, CNN, Yahoo Finance, Investing.com). **Stated honestly:** the primary source for that yield (FRED DGS10, Board of Governors) was fetched directly and its latest published observation is Sept 22 at 4.96  
is *not* primary-confirmed, and is not used to justify any part of this move. CME FedWatch odds of an Oct 28 hike rising to 66.4% from 55% are likewise a market price, never blended with the institutional SE  
research capability fully available, sourcing clears the sufficiency rule, verification clean.

**Sept 23 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-23\_draft), prior version:** checked for changes since the Sept 22 committed baseline. Three dated items found, none clearing the sufficiency bar: the 10-ye  
a market price, not scored); CME FedWatch showed 59.7% odds of an Oct 28 hike, but this figure is effectively single-sourced (one aggregator citing CME, not independently pulled from CME's own site); ar  
(primary, `federalreserve.gov`) was on discount-window/Treasury-market plumbing, off-topic for this pillar's P (no inflation or rate-path signal). No new jobless claims, PCE, CPI, retail sales, or housing data fo  
This is an ordinary light daily touch, research capability was fully available (WebSearch clean), no window moved, and the master call band did not flip — **AUTO-STAMPED per the runbook's delegated data**

**Sept 22 LIGHT DAILY touch (score set 2026-09-22\_draft), prior version:** a targeted single-pillar follow-up, not a full four-pillar pass — CLARITY Act, Iran War Risk, and Tokenization are carried forward u  
Federal Reserve surveys, both dated September 2026 and neither previously scored by any cycle including the Sept 19 weekly review: the Philadelphia Fed Manufacturing Business Outlook Survey (released  
corroborating outlets) showed general activity falling to 37.8 from 47.4 while **prices paid rose to 48.6 from 40.9** and **prices received rose to 31.3 from 17.7**; the New York Fed Empire State Manufacturing  
general business conditions cooling sharply to 7.6 from 20.6 while **prices paid jumped to 63.1 from 58.1** — the highest since July 2022 — and **prices received rose to 28.1 from 23.1**, a three-month high  
week, showing the same directional signal (headline activity cooling, input-cost and selling-price pressure both accelerating to multi-month/multi-year highs) clears the sufficiency bar — 2+ independent p  
because both are soft/sentiment surveys, not hard CPI/PCE prints; both releases' own forward-looking components (employment, future activity, general conditions) fell in the same reports; and market price  
~4.95%, BTC recovered) — reported as a market price, not scored, but the honest reason not to take this further. **P RE-RATED DOWN one point on the three near windows: 32/30/38/44/58 → 31/29/3**  
2027-2028 policy path those windows price. Research capability fully available this cycle (WebSearch clean; WebFetch reached `newyorkfed.org` directly). **Stamp decision: per CLAUDE.md's delegated auto**  
**and the sourcing clears the sufficiency rule — AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)"; left as "pending" here since that verification pass has not yet run.** No other

*Prior cycle (Sept 19 FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-09-19\_draft):* a full independent primary-source research pass (~15 targeted WebSearches, no capability degradation) re-checked every open thread.  
17) — the lowest since mid-July — reinforcing, not adding to, the already-priced hawkish read. New-residential-construction data (Census Bureau/HUD, primary, Sept 17) showed starts -2.6% m/m and per  
genuine but single-month, internally mixed cooling signal that did not clear the sufficiency bar alone. A high-profile political story also broke: President Trump and senior administration officials publicly pr  
Chair Warsh voted with a unanimous FOMC to hike anyway — a governance/Fed-independence storyline, not new economic evidence, logged rather than scored. Nothing that cycle cleared the sufficiency  
refresh, categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp authority regardless of the size of the move (there, zero) — LEFT AS DRAFT, flagged for Alex's manual review; still awaiting that review a

*Prior cycle (Sept 18 light daily touch, score set 2026-09-18\_draft):* re-checked — the Sept 16 FOMC dot-plot revision already drives this window's read in the current committed set; a Sept 18 Motley Fool pie  
the same already-priced primary Fed table this pillar cited Sept 17, not a new dated fact. **P HELD FLAT at 32/30/38/44/58.** Light daily touch, full research access, verification clean — **AUTO-STAMPED SEP**  
pillar that moved that cycle — see that report.

*Prior cycle (Sept 17 MERGE SET, 2026-09-17\_draft2) — why there were two Sept 17 sets, and what actually differed:* two independent runs researched that day: the cloud routine's, which committed and push  
local run became the `_draft2` of the same day, taking the cloud's committed set as its baseline rather than overwriting it. Three of the four pillars were carried forward from it untouched. Its CLARITY and I  
Kennedy's lame-duck remark, the Senate's early-October midterm recess, the Polymarket collapse reported as a market price; the Sept 9 IAEA referral and the Sept 12-13 NPT-withdrawal statement on the

**This pillar is the one thing corrected, and the disagreement is narrow and factual.** Both runs agree the hike was priced and the SEP is the mover; they differ on how far out it reaches. This run fetched d  
read Table 1: median federal funds **4.1% end-2026 and 4.1% end-2027**, against **3.6%** for 2027 in the June SEP, with 2028 at 3.9%, 2029 at 3.6% and longer run 3.2%. The cloud set described the 2027-28 p  
at 3.0% where the table's longer-run median is 3.2%, and held 12mo and 36mo flat as "broadly consistent with what the pillar already carried". Against the table that does not hold: a 50bp upward revision  
easing deleted, and the 1-year window is exactly what the old 3.6% median was underwriting. Five-plus independent outlets lead on that same revision. So 3mo goes one point deeper than the cloud set, 6

**Why 44 and not lower.** The strongest argument against this correction is not a number but a person: Chair Warsh submitted no dot at all — "I have refrained from offering any projections of my own, con  
business." The dots are eighteen individual forecasts and the one person who runs the meeting declined to make one. The longer-run median is still 3.2%, so easing is deferred rather than cancelled; the SE  
the bond market's first move on the hike was a yield drop. Census retail sales the same morning (+1.2% m/m, control group +1.4% against ~0.8% consensus) cut the other way and are why the correction w

**One correction to an earlier committed note, logged here rather than edited there.** The committed 2026-09-16\_draft note states that Thune filed the motion to reconsider on the CLARITY cloture v  
that, as a member of the prevailing side, he would be eligible to file it (Forbes, CoinDesk, FinanceFeeds, CryptoTimes — 4+ independent). Committed sets are never edited, so the attribution is corrected fo

**Stamp decision: AUTO-STAMPED.** Ordinary light daily touch, not a weekly refresh; research capability fully available, with both Federal Reserve primary documents fetched directly rather than read through  
neither the size of the move nor the call-band flips are grounds to withhold the stamp.

**Sept 16 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-16\_draft), prior cycle:** the FOMC decision, statement, SEP and dot plot were scheduled for 2:00pm ET that day and had NOT been released at run time (~  
Light daily touch, master call band unchanged everywhere — **AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."** Iran War Risk and CLARITY Act both moved that cycle on the Sen

*Prior cycle (Sept 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh, score set 2026-09-12\_draft2):* the week's deeper research turned up one genuinely new primary-sourced release — the August PPI (BLS, primary, released Sept 10, c  
directional: the 5.4% y/y headline is the highest of 2026, yet more than three-quarters of the monthly gain is attributable to volatile energy costs (diesel fuel +24.1% alone), and core PPI actually undershot  
disinflationary surprise that reinforces, rather than contradicts, the already-priced cooler-than-consensus August CPI read. This pillar also independently re-verified the August CPI print itself (BLS, Sept 11 v  
206,000) were steady and unremarkable. CME FedWatch-tracked Sept 15-16 hike odds read ~62-69% this week (as of Sept 10-11) — a market price, not used to move P, and flagged for the record as mean  
both are market-price snapshots at different times, the divergence noted but not resolved. A Sept 9 Marketplace piece characterizing Chair Warsh as withholding forward guidance ahead of the meeting is

FOMC meeting itself has NOT yet occurred as of this research — it remains this pillar's next real catalyst, most acute on the 1mo/3mo windows. **P HELD FLAT at 34/33/44/54/60.** This is a FULL WEEKLY ref auto-stamp authority regardless of findings (the sufficiency rule was satisfied — primary source, 3+ independent outlets — but the finding itself is inconclusive/reinforcing, not a fresh directional catalyst), so Risk, CLARITY Act, and Tokenization each report their own weekly research separately — see those reports.

Prior cycle (Sept 12 light daily catch-up, score set 2026-09-12, draft): re-checked — no new Fed speech or primary data release found since the Sept 11 CPI print. That morning's coverage of ~90% market-in Jackson Hole remarks ("if the numbers don't improve, we have work to do"), not a fresh statement, and the hike-odds figure was a market price, not used to move P under the house sufficiency rule. **P HELD** unchanged anywhere (Neutral → Neutral equal-weight, Mild Bull → Mild Bull horizon-weighted) — so per the runbook's delegated daily auto-stamp authority, **this set was AUTO-STAMPED: status comm** moved that cycle — see that report.

**Sept 11 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-1\_draft), prior cycle:** the August CPI print landed on schedule at 8:30am ET: BLS's own release (bls.gov, primary, fetched directly and re-fetched to confirm), **NSA**, with core (all items less food and energy) **+0.3% m/m** after +0.2% in July and **+2.4% y/y**; energy rose 2.1% m/m and gasoline 3.9%, accounting for over a third of the monthly increase, while shelter +0.4% m/m / 2.4% y/y), headline landed exactly in line and **core came in one tenth cooler on the month**, core y/y in line. That is the dated primary print this pillar has flagged as its next catalyst for a headline accelerated from -0.1% to +0.4% and the acceleration is energy-driven — the same oil shock that fires the Iran pillar's "sustained Brent >\$100" clause this cycle shows up here as headline inflation (move) are a *market price*, reported and not used to move P; the BLS release itself is the mover. Cross-source caution logged: several aggregator summaries of this print circulating within minutes carried fig primary document. **P RE-RATED UP, modestly, to 34/33/44/54/60** — 1mo 32→34, 3mo 31→33, 6mo 43→44, concentrated on the windows bracketing the Sept 15-16 FOMC; 12mo and 36mo held flat at 54. Note the direction: this is the first upward move in this pillar since Aug 13, and it only partly offsets the Sept 5 cut. Light daily touch, master call band unchanged everywhere (Neutral → Neutral equal-weight auto-stamp authority, **this set is AUTO-STAMPED: status committed, stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped),"** Iran War Risk also moved this cycle, down, as its Brent flip-line clause fired — see that report.

**Sept 10 light daily catch-up (score set 2026-09-10 draft), prior cycle:** re-checked — the Aug CPI release (due Sept 11) and the Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting both remain pending per BLS/Fed calendars; **32/31/43/54/60.** Light daily touch, no window moved, master call band unchanged anywhere (Neutral → Neutral equal-weight, Mild Bull → Mild Bull horizon-weighted) — so per the runbook's delegated **stamped by "Alex (auto-stamped)."** Iran War Risk is the pillar that moved this cycle — see that report.

*Prior cycle (Sept 9 light daily catch-up):* re-checked directly against CME FedWatch-citing coverage — September hike odds read ~58.7%, consistent with the already-priced cluster; no new FOMC meeting,

*Prior cycle (Sept 8 light daily catch-up):* re-checked via WebSearch — no new Fed speech, data release, or FOMC commentary since Sept 3-4; the Sept 11 CPI print and Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting remained

*Prior cycle (Sept 6 light daily catch-up):* re-checked via WebSearch — no new Fed speech or data release since Sept 3-4; Sept 6 was a Saturday, markets and the Fed's calendar quiet. **AUTO-STAMPED SEPT**

Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05\_draft2) — *carried forward for context*: independently re-verified via WebSearch: Fed Governor Waller's genuinely dovish-leaning Sept 3 speech ("give disinflation a chance") and Sept 4 jobs beat reversed that back up to 60-66% (Forbes/CME FedWatch) — a net hawkish drift for the week consistent with the Sept 5 cut. **HELD FLAT at 32/31/43/54/60. COMMITTED BY ALEX SEPTEMBER 5, 2026**

**CORRECTION** — **flagged this cycle**: the prior same-day light daily catch-up (2026-09-05\_draft) reported "COMMITTED — AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 5, 2026" in its commit message, but config/scores.json session. The last TRUE committed baseline for this pillar remains **2026-09-02\_draft (36/35/45/55/61), auto-stamped Sept 3**. Not corrected retroactively in scores.json — stamping is Alex's call.

Prior cycle (Sept 2 light daily catch-up) — carried forward for context: held flat at 36/35/45/55/61; originally left as draft only because Iran War Risk's re-rate flipped the master call band, not for any reason in the delegated daily auto-stamp policy. A Sept 3 check found nothing material on any pillar; config/scores.json was untouched that cycle.

Prior cycle (Sept 1 light daily catch-up) — carried forward for context: re-checked CME FedWatch odds and found continued drift, not a fresh shock: September hike odds moved to ~66% (Forbes/KuCoin, 11 H.4.1 or jobless claims release landed (Aug 31 was Labor Day). P held flat, AUTO-STAMPED, then the committed baseline.

Prior cycle (Aug 31 light daily catch-up) — carried forward for context: re-checked CME FedWatch odds and found continued drift, not a fresh shock: September hike odds moved from the ~56-58% cluster piece, up from ~56% Friday). No new H.4.1 or jobless claims release landed. P held flat, AUTO-STAMPED.

Prior cycle (Aug 29 full weekly refresh) — carried forward for context: Fed & Macro re-rated down further that cycle than a same-day catch-up draft written August 28 (score set 2026-08-28\_draft) reached — abandoned, superseded by this full weekly refresh. The underlying trigger is the same one that draft identified: Fed Chair Warsh's first Jackson Hole speech as Chair (federalreserve.gov primary transcript, <https://www.federalreserve.gov/newswriting/20260828warsh.htm>, Reuters/investing.com, CNN, and Yahoo Finance), which said cooler summer PCE/CPI readings "do not tell me that underlying trends have meaningfully improved." A dedicated adversarial-verification pass hike-odds figure (~35.4%→~45.7%) understated the actual market move. Independent re-pull and cross-check instead clusters tightly in the high-50s — Motley Fool at 57.5% (citing CME FedWatch directly meaning September hike odds are now past coin-flip, not just approaching it. This cycle also corrects the abandoned draft's "stable tape" characterization of BTC's reaction: BTC fell from above \$81,000 pre routine facts round out the picture: jobless claims (week ended Aug 22) came in tight at 203K vs. 208K consensus, and the Aug 26 H.4.1 release showed the known reserve-drain pattern continuing — neither deeper cut than the abandoned draft reached: 1mo -7, 3mo -6, 6mo -3, 1yr -1, 3yr -1 versus the last committed baseline — minimal at the long end since Warsh explicitly declined to commit to a reaction

*(That Aug 29 cycle was left as a draft solely because full weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated daily auto-stamp authority, regardless of move size — not for any evidentiary reason; every w*

The prior committed scores were **34 / 33 / 44 / 54 / 60** (2026-09-16\_draft), re-rated down to **32 / 31 / 42 / 54 / 60** (2026-09-17\_draft, cloud) and corrected further to **32 / 30 / 38 / 44 / 58** (2026-09-17\_c  
federal funds rate reads 4.1% against 3.6% in June. **32 / 30 / 38 / 44 / 58 has now held flat for two straight cycles (Sept 17, Sept 18)** — nothing this cycle cleared the sufficiency bar to move it further —

**Override any P and re-stamp — the master blend recomputes.**

## What Changed Since Last Check

FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 26, 2026 (score set **2026-09-26\_draft3, COMMITTED BY ALEX, September 27, 2026**) — checked against the last COMMITTED baseline, 2026-09-23\_draft (31/29/37/44/58). Four independent pri

**October 3, 2026 — FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-10-03\_draft), LEFT AS DRAFT: RE-RATED UP, 27/25/34/43/58 — 35/29/37/44/58 (+8/+4/+3/+1/0) — the largest move of this cycle, and** broke dovish on primary data. **1mo 27 → 35:** August PCE undershot (3.4% headline / 3.0% core, BEA Sept 30) and September payrolls came in at +29,000 against ~84,000 expected with unemployment at 4.1% (vs 4.5% expected), **contradicting Barr's Sept 29 claim** that "risks to the labor market have receded." The Oct 27–28 FOMC sits inside this window and now prices as a hold (~17–23% hike odds, CME FedWatch, a market move to 2.25% on Oct 27), **and a December hike remains the base case** (roughly mid-60s to mid-70s percent), so the cycle is *deferred by about six weeks, not ended*. **6mo 34 → 37:** core PCE at 3.0% and wage growth down to 2.9% (vs 3.1% expected), **rose to 5.29% on Sept 30 even as the 2-year fell to 4.78%, and a steepening like that is a structural drag** no single month of cooler data fixes. **36mo held at 58:** nothing structural changed. **Why the 2026 cycle is the longest** which is stated rather than glossed — Q2 GDP was revised sharply up to 2.2%, and claims at 197,000 say the labour softening is a hiring freeze rather than a firing wave. **Corrections this cycle:** the 2026 cycle is the longest (vs 2020's lowest); two Barr quotations had been truncated while presented as verbatim and are restored in full; the December FedWatch figure is corrected down from "above 75%"; and DGS2 for Sept 2026 is corrected down from 2.5% to 2.25%.

- **Oct 2 light daily touch (quant-only; qualitative set unchanged):** re-checked this pillar via WebSearch for any new scheduled Fed speech or data release. None found for Oct 1-2; the Sept 30 release is not a sufficiency bar. **HOLD FLAT — nothing cleared the sufficiency rule.** config/scores.json untouched; active set remains 2026-09-26\_draft3.
- **Oct 1 light daily touch (quant-only; qualitative set unchanged) — August PCE and the Q2 GDP third estimate, the test this report flagged as outstanding, both landed Sept 30, 2026** y/y previously — but a meaningful share of that apparent cooling is mechanical: BEA implemented a methodology overhaul to the PCE price index on this same release (telegraphed since June 2025, but a point drag on core y/y), so this is not read as fresh disinflation evidence. Separately, Q2 GDP (third estimate) was revised sharply **up to +2.2%** annualized (from 1.5%), with GDI +2.6% — a genuine growth). The two releases roughly offset rather than confirming or reversing this cycle's hawkish cut. A government shutdown was separately averted (H.R. 6500, funding through Dec 11, 2026). FOMC commentary found dated after Sept 24-25 in this window. **HOLD FLAT — the PCE/GDP data landed but nets out two-sided, clearing no sufficiency bar either way.** config/scores.json untouched.
- ★ **★ SUPERSESSION NOTICE, stated first because it affects how you should read everything else.** A 2026-09-24\_draft cycle proposed 29/27/36/44/58 on this pillar and edited this report to reflect its edits asserted "COMMITTED · AUTO-STAMPED" for a set still marked draft in config/scores.json. Per house convention it is treated as not-delivered, drops out of the visible lineage column. **abandoned draft was VINDICATED:** both its Fed claims held up, and the two "corrections" a first-pass research effort made to them were themselves wrong and are withdrawn (see the next section for pieces of evidence landed after it).
- ★ **★ NEW — Fed Governor Michael S. Barr, Sept 23 (PRIMARY, verbatim, local text extraction).** All three load-bearing sentences confirmed on p.2 of *barr20260923a.pdf*, including **"In my view, the economy comes down to target in a timely fashion."** *Two withdrawn corrections:* a first pass reported the "risks ... have receded" sentence as ABSENT and moved the start time to 10:20 a.m.; the sentence was later moved to Chair Jefferson at the NY Fed). Both are logged rather than silently fixed, because the abandoned draft had them right.
- ★ **★ NEW — S&P Global flash US PMI, Sept 23, now PRIMARY.** The embargoed release was retrieved directly, upgrading this from secondary: composite 58.4, manufacturing 57.0, services 58.0. The "input prices index 66.4 from 59.9" reading circulating in secondary coverage does not appear in the release — it is vendor data and is not quoted.
- ★ **★ NEW — UMich final September, Sept 25 (PRIMARY).** Year-ahead inflation expectations 4.0% → 4.6%; **long-run 3.3% → 3.4%, ending three consecutive months at 3.3%;** sentiment 48.0.

- ★ ★ **NEW — DOL claims, Sept 24 (PRIMARY): 197,000** for the week ended Sept 19; prior week **revised up to 198,000** and the 4-week average now **202,250** — both correcting stale figures
- ★ ★ **NEW — H.4.1, Sept 24 (PRIMARY, arithmetic checked): reserve balances –\$83,601M week-over-week** to \$2,930,193M, with TGA +\$100,056M. The largest one-week drain logged here
- **Two Fed voices, DOWNGRADED on sourcing after verification.** Collins (Sept 22) is quoted correctly but traces entirely to one Reuters story — **effectively single-agency**, and never scored asserting his own view, and hedged with “but we have to see”; no primary transcript exists and genuinely independent reporting is two outlets. Both corroborate; neither could move P alone.
- **Why this clears the sufficiency bar:** one primary Federal Reserve source, verbatim from the Fed’s own server and extracted locally rather than summarised, plus four further primary data releases on any leg of the move.
- **MARKET PRICES, reported and never mixed with the SEP:** the 10-year yield 4.96% → 5.11% → 5.18% (Sept 22–24), highest since 2007 — now **double-primary-confirmed** by the FRED CSV “published Sept 23 yet” caveat and supersedes its press-sourced 5.104%. CME FedWatch October-hike odds ~53% → 77.5% → ~70–76%; traders now price ~four more hikes by June 2027, retail **was RETRACTED, not printed** — verification could not reproduce it and traced it to a summarizer reading a truncated file.
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN to 27/25/34/43/58** (–4/–4/–3/–1/0). **LEFT AS DRAFT, NOT AUTO-STAMPED** — a full weekly refresh is categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamped; *not* degraded: federalreserve.gov, dol.gov, treasury.gov, the UMich survey and the S&P Global release were all reached directly.
- **What would change my mind, in order:** August PCE and Q2 GDP landed **Sept 30** and came back two-sided (see What Changed) — not itself a trigger; next is whether the Oct 27–28 FOMC

Carried forward — what changed in the September 23 light daily touch (2026-09-23\_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- **10-year Treasury yield ~4.96-4.97% Sept 22**, essentially flat (CNBC, TradingEconomics — two-source, but a market price, not scored).
- **CME FedWatch: 59.7% odds of an Oct 28 hike** — effectively single-sourced (one aggregator citing CME, not independently pulled from CME’s own site); does not clear the bar.
- **Fed Vice Chair Jefferson’s Sept 22 speech** at the NY Fed’s Treasury Market Conference (primary, federalreserve.gov) — discount-window/Treasury-market plumbing, off-topic for this pillar’s
- No new jobless claims, PCE, CPI, retail sales, or housing data found dated in this window.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 31/29/37/44/58.** AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 22 light daily touch (2026-09-22\_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle — Philadelphia Fed Manufacturing Business Outlook Survey, released Sept 17, 2026 (primary source page confirmed at philadelphiafed.org, 5+ independent corroborations)** — **48.6 from 40.9** and **prices received rose to 31.3 from 17.7**; employment fell sharply (11.8 from 27.9) and future activity fell (52.9 from 73.6).
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle — New York Fed Empire State Manufacturing Survey, released Sept 15, 2026 (PRIMARY, fetched directly from newyorkfed.org):** general business conditions cooled since July 2022 — and **prices received rose to 28.1 from 23.1**, a three-month high.
- **Why this clears the sufficiency bar:** two independent Fed district banks’ own primary surveys, same week, same directional signal (headline cooling, input-cost/selling-price pressure re-accepted)
- **Why only one point:** both are soft/sentiment surveys whose own forward-looking components also fell, and market pricing turned risk-on into Sept 18-19 (10-year off its 5.04% high to ~4.9%)
- **CLARITY Act, Iran War Risk, and Tokenization carried forward unchanged** — not re-researched this cycle; this is a targeted single-pillar touch, not a full weekly pass.
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN one point on 1mo/3mo/6mo, 32/30/38/44/58 → 31/29/37/44/58;** 12mo/36mo held. Sourcing clears the sufficiency rule — **AUTO-STAMPED: status confirmed**

Carried forward — what changed in the September 19 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-19\_draft, still draft), for continuity:

FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 19, 2026 (score set **2026-09-19\_draft**, draft, awaiting Alex’s stamp) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-18\_draft committed baseline. **This pillar HELD FLAT at 32/30/38/44/58.**

- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle — jobless claims, week ended Sept 12 (DOL, primary, released Sept 17): 196,000**, the lowest since mid-July; four-week average 203,250. Confirmatory of the already-priced
- ★ ★ **NEW this cycle — housing data (Census Bureau/HUD and NAR, primary, released Sept 17 and Sept 10): housing starts –2.6% m/m, permits –2.7% m/m, existing-home sales –2.2% m/m** (starts actually +7.6%) — insufficient alone to move P.
- **Background color, not scored — University of Michigan preliminary September sentiment fell to 47.8 from 51.7**, near a record low, with 1yr inflation expectations up to 4.6%; predates
- **Market-price context, not scored:** the 10-year Treasury briefly touched a 19-year high near 5.04% before settling near 4.95%; CME FedWatch prices 55.1% odds of another hike at the October
- **Logged, not scored — a high-profile political story:** President Trump and senior administration officials publicly pressured the Fed against hiking, with Trump demanding rates be cut to “1%” — corroborated across 8+ independent outlets — a governance/Fed-independence storyline, not new economic evidence.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 32/30/38/44/58.** Full independent primary-source research this cycle; nothing cleared the sufficiency bar. FULL WEEKLY refresh — categorically excluded from manual review.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 18 light daily touch (2026-09-18\_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 18, 2026 (score set **2026-09-18\_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-17\_draft2 committed baseline. **This pillar HELD FLAT at 32/30/38/44/58.**

- **Re-checked for a new dated development — found none.** The Sept 16 FOMC dot-plot revision already drives this window’s read in the currently committed set.
- **A Sept 18 Motley Fool piece discussing “the most important number” in the Fed’s Summary of Economic Projections is single-source commentary** on the same already-priced primary (correction) — not a new dated fact, does not move P.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 32/30/38/44/58.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar. AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 17 light daily touch (2026-09-17\_draft / draft2, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 17, 2026 (score set **2026-09-17\_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-16\_draft committed baseline. **This pillar RE-RATED DOWN to 32/31/42/54/60 (cloudy)**

- **The September FOMC decision landed:** the Fed raised the federal funds target range 25bp to 3.75%-4.00% (12-0 vote), its first hike in three years (federalreserve.gov, primary; corroborated across 8+ independent outlets) — ~92.5% priced into market odds beforehand, so per the sufficiency rule it does not alone move P.
- **The SEP/dot plot is new primary information:** 16 of 18 officials expect another 2026 hike (12 of 18 pencil in one more 25bp move by year-end to 4.125%); a slower, more cautious 2027-2028
- **Bitcoin’s reaction was muted** (~\$76,300 on the statement, drifting back to hold near \$76,000-198) — consistent with the hike being anticipated; the incremental signal is in the dot plot, not the price
- **Score decision: RE-RATED DOWN to 32/31/42/54/60** — 1mo 34→32, 3mo 33→31, 6mo 44→42; 12mo/36mo held flat. **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.**

Carried forward — what changed in the September 16 light daily touch (2026-09-16\_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 16, 2026 (score set **2026-09-16\_draft**, committed, auto-stamped) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-15\_draft committed baseline. **This pillar HELD FLAT at 34/33/44/54/60.**

- **The September FOMC decision had not landed yet.** The decision, statement, Summary of Economic Projections and dot plot were scheduled for **September 16 at 2:00pm ET**, with the press conference at 3:00pm
- **No new BLS/Fed/BEA primary release found** since the August CPI/PPI prints already priced.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 34/33/44/54/60.** No window moved; nothing new cleared the sufficiency bar.

Carried forward — what changed in the September 15 light daily touch (2026-09-15\_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 15, 2026 (score set **2026-09-15\_draft**) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-14\_draft committed baseline.

- **The September FOMC convened Sept 15, but nothing was knowable yet.** The decision, statement, SEP and dot plot did not land until Sept 16 at 2:00pm ET. Markets leaned toward a 25bp hike on the August jobs report — a read already priced into this set; market-implied odds are market prices, never used to move a P.

- **No new BLS/Fed/BEA primary release** since the August CPI (Sept 11) and August PPI (Sept 10) already priced.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 34/33/44/54/60.**

Carried forward — what changed in the September 14 light daily touch (2026-09-14\_draft, committed, auto-stamped), for continuity:

LIGHT DAILY touch, September 14, 2026 (score set **2026-09-14\_draft**) — checking for changes since the 2026-09-13\_draft committed baseline.

- **No new primary macro release since the last check.** Nothing from BLS, the Federal Reserve, or BEA landed Sept 13-14; the August CPI (released Sept 11) and August PPI (released Sept 10) already priced.
- **The September 15-16 FOMC — with the SEP and dot plot — has not yet happened.** The decision and statement are due **September 16**. That is the next dated catalyst for this pillar and its market-implied September hike odds.
- **Market-implied hike odds are a MARKET PRICE and are explicitly not used to move P.** Reads circulating this week span a wide **66-83%** band across sources for a 25bp hike — reported hiked.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 34/33/44/54/60.** No window moved. Nothing dated and primary-sourced arrived to move it.

Carried forward — the September 12 FULL WEEKLY refresh, for continuity:

FULL WEEKLY refresh, September 12, 2026 — checking for changes since this morning's committed baseline (2026-09-12\_draft, auto-stamped).

- **Re-verified August CPI (BLS, released Sept 11) independently:** headline +0.4% m/m / +3.4% y/y, core +0.3% m/m / +2.4% y/y, shelter +0.3% m/m / +3.0% y/y — matches the figures already priced.
- ★ **★ NEW this cycle — August PPI (BLS, primary, released Sept 10, 2026; corroborated by CNBC, CNN, Yahoo Finance — 3+ independent outlets).** Headline final demand +0.4% m/m (in quarters of the monthly gain is attributable to volatile energy costs (diesel fuel +24.1% alone). Core PPI (ex food/energy) came in at +0.3% m/m, UNDER consensus on one reading (+0.2% m/m) on the core reading. **Net read: reinforces, rather than contradicts, the already-priced "cooler than consensus" CPI narrative — not a distinct new directional catalyst, so it does not move P.**
- **DOL initial jobless claims, week ending Sept 5 (released ~Sept 11, primary): 206,000, down 1,000 w/w, 4-week average 206,000** — steady, unremarkable, no signal.
- **CME FedWatch-tracked market-implied odds of a 25bp hike at the Sept 15-16 FOMC read ~62-69% this week (as of Sept 10-11) — a market price only, not an institutional estimate.** ~90% figure referenced in the prior (this morning's) daily cycle's background note — both reported as market-price snapshots at different times, the divergence noted, not resolved or editorialized.
- **Fed Chair Warsh: no new substantive remarks since the Aug 28 Jackson Hole speech.** A Sept 9 Marketplace piece characterizing him as withholding forward guidance ahead of the meeting was flagged as single-source, does not move P.
- **The Sept 15-16, 2026 FOMC meeting has NOT yet occurred** as of this research (Sept 12) — flagged prominently as this pillar's next real catalyst, most acute on the 1mo/3mo windows, rather than the market-implied September hike odds.
- **Score decision: P HELD FLAT at 34/33/44/54/60 — FULL WEEKLY REFRESH, left as DRAFT for Alex's manual review (weekly refreshes are categorically excluded from delegated auto-stamp policy).**

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 12 light daily catch-up (2026-09-12\_draft, auto-stamped this morning), for continuity:

- **Re-checked — no new Fed speech or primary data release found since the Sept 11 CPI print.** The Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting remains the next dated catalyst.
- **Logged, not scored:** that morning's coverage of ~90% market-implied September hike odds and Fed Chair Warsh's hawkish framing traced to his Aug 28 Jackson Hole remarks, not a fresh SEP or P.
- **Score decision: P HELD FLAT at 34/33/44/54/60.** No window moved, master call band unchanged everywhere — **AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority**, the last COMMITTED baseline.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 10 light daily catch-up, for continuity:

- **Sept 10, light daily catch-up:** re-checked — the Aug CPI release (due Sept 11) and the Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting both remained pending per BLS/Fed calendars; no new Fed speech or primary data release found.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 9 light daily catch-up, for continuity:

- **Sept 9, light daily catch-up:** re-checked directly against CME FedWatch-citing coverage — September 25bp-hike odds read ~58.7% (as of Sept 7, CNBC/cryptonews), consistent with the ~56% BLS/DOL primary release since Sept 3-4; the Sept 11 CPI print and Sept 15-16 FOMC remain the next dated catalysts.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 32/31/43/54/60 — AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.**

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 8 light daily catch-up, for continuity:

- **Sept 8, light daily catch-up:** re-checked via WebSearch — no new Fed speech, data release, or FOMC commentary since Sept 3-4. The Sept 11 CPI print and the Sept 15-16 FOMC meeting remain the next dated catalysts.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 32/31/43/54/60 — AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.**

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 6 light daily catch-up, for continuity:

- **Sept 6, light daily catch-up:** re-checked via WebSearch — no new Fed speech, data release, or FOMC commentary since Sept 3-4 (Waller's dovish-leaning Sept 3 speech and the Sept 4 BLS release). September 55,000 consensus, unemployment steady 4.1%). September 6 is a Saturday — no data or speeches scheduled. The Sept 11 CPI print remains the next dated catalyst and has not yet landed.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 32/31/43/54/60.** No window moved; nothing this cycle clears the sufficiency bar for a further move in either direction.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 5 FULL WEEKLY refresh (2026-09-05\_draft2, committed by Alex Sept 5), for continuity:

- ★ **★ NEW — August jobs report (BLS, primary, Sept 4): nonfarm payrolls +162,000 vs. ~53-55,000 consensus, unemployment steady 4.1%.** Corroborated by CNBC, Yahoo Finance, TheStreet.com.
- ★ **★ NEW — Sept 15-16 FOMC hike-odds pricing moved higher off the jobs beat** (roughly 60-66% across sources, up from the Sept 2 baseline's "~60% hold" framing); 2yr yield +5.3bp to its prior (\$81,265.00→\$79,676.60).
- **Score decision: RE-CONFIRMED the re-rate at 32/31/43/54/60** (1mo -4, 3mo -4, 6mo -2, 1yr -1, 3yr -1 vs. the Sept 2 TRUE committed baseline) — the fresh, dated, primary-sourced jobs-report dovish-leaning Sept 3 speech. This is a FULL WEEKLY refresh, categorically excluded from the delegated daily auto-stamp policy, so it went to manual review — **COMMITTED BY ALEX SEPTEMBER 5, 2026**.
- **Correction:** the same-day earlier 2026-09-05\_draft's commit message claimed it was auto-stamped, but config/scores.json's status field was never actually advanced — a bug in that session. Retroactively.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 3 light daily catch-up (no new score set), for continuity:

- **Re-checked CME FedWatch and the H.4.1/data calendar; nothing material found on any pillar dated Sept 2-3.** config/scores.json untouched; blend re-run against fresh quant data only.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 2 light daily catch-up (2026-09-02\_draft), for continuity:

- **No new H.4.1 or data print found dated Sept 1-2.** September 15-16 FOMC market pricing (CME FedWatch roughly 60% hold) continued the same post-Jackson-Hole drift already priced in the pillar's own standing discipline against chasing drift, it did not independently move P.
- **BTC traded at \$76,581.44 on Sept 2** — down from \$78,038.78 on Sept 1 (Bitstamp), a real pullback driven by the Iran War Risk escalation covered in that pillar's report, not by anything here.
- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 36/35/45/55/61.** No window moved for this pillar. This cycle's shared score set (2026-09-02\_draft) was originally left as draft — Iran War Risk's sharp re-rate flip was **AUTO-STAMPED SEPTEMBER 3, 2026**, once Alex widened the delegated daily auto-stamp policy.

Carried forward — what changed in the Sept 1 light daily catch-up (2026-09-01\_draft, auto-stamped), for continuity:

- **CME FedWatch September hike odds continued drifting up, not a fresh shock:** ~60.4% (Aug 31 baseline, CNBC) → ~66% (Forbes/KuCoin, 11:40am ET Aug 31) — the same post-Jackson-Hole odds drift alone cannot move P per the sufficiency rule and this pillar's own standing discipline against chasing drift.
- **No new H.4.1 or jobless claims release landed Aug 31-Sept 1** — Aug 31 was Labor Day, a US federal holiday; next H.4.1 is due Sept 3.
- **BTC traded at \$78,038.78 on Sept 1** — down from \$78,447.16 on Aug 31 (Bitstamp).

- **CME FedWatch September hike odds continued drifting up, not a fresh shock:** ~56-58% (Aug 29 baseline) → ~57% (CoinSpectator/Bitcoin.com, Aug 30) → ~60.4% (CNBC Jackson-Hole-  
fresh primary print or news event, cannot move P per the sufficiency rule.

- **Score decision: HELD FLAT at 36/35/45/55/61.** AUTO-STAMPED per delegated daily authority.

★ **ADVERSARIAL CORRECTION** — the abandoned Aug 28 draft's CME FedWatch September hike-odds figure was wrong. Corrected from ~35.4%→~45.7% to the real ~35%→~56-58% independent read at 55.7%) — past coin-flip, not just approaching it.

- Carried forward — the abandoned Aug 28 catch-up draft (2026-08-28\_draft) was written but never rendered, selfchecked, archived, or committed, for continuity.*

- **NEW — FOMC minutes' hawkish bloc wider than previously known:** beyond the three named dissenters, "several participants" also favored a hike and "many participants" saw tightening corroborated by CNBC, Quartz, Newsquawk, goldsilver.com).

- Retrieved & graded September 19, 2026, FULL WEEKLY refresh — click and judge the quality yourself. Official data first, then reporting, then prices & flows, then rate odds (market-implied sentiment, not fact). This cycle: DOL jobs sentiment, CME FedWatch, and the Trump/Fed political-pressure story across 8+ independent outlets.

- **August PCE (PRIMARY, re-confirmed exact):** [bea.gov/news/2026/personal-income-and-outlays-august-2026](https://bea.gov/news/2026/personal-income-and-outlays-august-2026) — headline +0.3% m/m / 3.4% y/y, core +0.2% / 3.0%, real PCE +0.6%; embeds the annual update of the N

